

WHO'S WHO
IN IRAD

2026–27

THIRTY-FIRST EDITION

THE TALAS HERALD

TALAS

WHO'S WHO

IN IRAD

2026–27

A biographical dictionary of notable Iradis of the present day, with a Historical Section of those whose deaths have been recorded

THIRTY-FIRST EDITION

Compiled and edited by the staff of

THE TALAS HERALD

HERALD PUBLISHING COMPANY

Talas · 2026

First edition 1995
Annually since, except 2007, when no edition appeared
Thirty-first edition, revised to 1 October 2026

© Herald Publishing Company, Talas, 2026
No part of this book may be reproduced without the written permission of the publishers, except by the press for review.

Legal deposit LD 2026/214. Irad has no ISBN agency: please quote the LD number and the title when ordering.
Registered with the Department of Public Information.

Set in the Herald's composing room and printed by the Herald Publishing Company, Talas.
Price 450 som. Orders by post to the Herald, or at the Herald's front office.

CONTENTS

Preface 5
Abbreviations and signs 6
Biographies 7
Historical Section 39
Advertisements 52

PREFACE

Who's Who in Irad first appeared in 1995, when the Herald was two years old and the territory had a legislature, a governor and a great many new names that our readers wanted to put faces to. It has appeared every year since, with the single exception of 2007. This is the thirty-first edition.

Its purpose is unchanged: to give, in a small compass, the plain facts of the lives of men and women whose work or office makes them of public interest in Irad, wherever they live. Inclusion is decided by the editors alone. It is not bought, it cannot be refused, and it implies neither praise nor blame. The book records offices held; it does not judge how they were held.

Each June the editors send a questionnaire to everyone entered in the previous edition and to those proposed for the first time. Most entries are printed as the biographees returned them, shortened to the house style. Where no questionnaire came back, the editors have compiled the entry from public records, court lists, the Official Gazette and the files of the Herald; such entries are marked with a dagger (†) and are usually short. A biographee who wishes to correct or extend an entry is asked to write to the editors, and will receive a questionnaire in good time for the next edition. The facts are given as at 1 October 2026.

Entries are made under the name by which a person is known in public life. Where the Soviet registration of a surname differs, it is given after the date of birth. Those who use the patronymic form (*uulu*,*kyzy*) are entered under their own given name, so that BEKTUR Zhumabek uulu will be found among the B's. The letters*ı*,*ñ*,*ö* and*ü* are filed with*i*,*n*,*o* and*u*.

The**Historical Section** at the back of the book contains Iradis whose deaths have been recorded, from the founders of the modern state to the artists of the last century, together with those removed from the main list since the previous edition. The editors are always glad to hear of a death that has escaped them.

Portraits are reproduced from photographs supplied by the biographees or held in the Herald's library.

The editors thank the many readers, offices and institutions that sent corrections in the past year, and the staff of the Herald's library, without whom the book could not be made.

Elmira Beishenova, Editor, The Talas Herald
Talas, October 2026

ABBREVIATIONS AND SIGNS

ATR	Autonomous Tribal Regions
Cand. Sc.	Candidate of Sciences (Soviet doctorate)
D.Sc.	Doctor of Sciences
DPI	Democratic Party of Irad
DRI	Democratic Republic of Irad (2006–07)
F.C.	Football Club
IAC	Iradi Freedom Society (Iradin Azatlık Cemiyeti)
ISEZ	Irad Special Economic Zone
ISSR	Iradi Soviet Socialist Republic
LL.M.	Master of Laws
q.v.	which see (an entry of that name in this book)
TSU	Talas State University (formerly Iradi State University)
†	entry compiled by the editors

HOW TO READ AN ENTRY

Each entry opens with the name in bold, the surname in capitals, followed by the present office or calling. Then come, where known, the date and place of birth, parents, marriage, children, education, career, publications or works, decorations, clubs and recreations, religion and an address for correspondence. Dates are given in full where the biographee has supplied them, and as a year where only the year is a matter of record. An address is not necessarily a residence.

The Herald regrets that it cannot forward letters to biographees, or say why a name does not appear. A name may be absent because its bearer has left public life, because the editors have not yet been able to confirm the facts, or because space is limited.

ABDRASULOV, Daniyar. Deputy Director, Customs Service, 2013–22. Born 1971. Customs officer, Chu Gate crossing, territorial period; in charge of the northern crossings and the Talas North Terminal, 2013–22; resigned 2022. Party: DPI. Address: Talas.

ABDYKALYKOV, Nurlan. Head of a Kyrgyz village in the eastern Talas valley. Born 1959. In 2015 he led the village petition against a gravel quarry planned on the Otmek above Orto-Ayyl; after 1,100 signatures the district withdrew the permit (Talas Herald, Jul 2015). Address: Orto-Ayyl.

ABDYKERIMOV, Mar Narsai. Bishop of the Chatkal Highlands since 2010 (no fixed seat; visits the highland parishes on horseback, spring to autumn). Born Chatkal Highlands, 1962. Education: St. Ephrem Major Seminary, Iyık Janyl, 1992–97. Career: priest of the highland parishes from 1997. Address: Iyık Janyl.

AIBEK Ulan uulu. TSU student leader in the 2023 protests, expelled and later readmitted. Born 1998. He spoke for the students at the Central Square sit-in; readmitted in 2024 after a Legal Defense Guild appeal, he graduated in law in 2025. Address: Talas.

AIDANA Tashbolot kyzy. TSU law graduate from the ATR who interprets for UNMI at the ceasefire table. Born 1995. In 2021 she compiled Jaiyt menen Suu ("Pasture and Water"), an Iradi–English glossary of the talks' pasture, water and boundary terms (TSU Press). Address: ATR, now Talas.

AIDAR Jorobek uulu. Nurzhan city councillor and chairman of the dacha cooperatives' union. Born 1960. Registered Zhorobekov. In 2018 he led a petition of some 4,000 dacha owners that won back the cooperatives' summer irrigation schedule. Address: Nurzhan.

AIKAN Bektur kyzy. Mining engineer at Sary-Bulak, the first woman to run an underground shift. Born 1990. Registered Bekturova. Her father was a Sary-Bulak miner, and she took the job in 2018 over the objections of the shift foremen. Address: Sary-Bulak.



Aikokul Tursunbek kyzy

AIKOKUL Tursunbek kyzy. Writer and teacher. Born Talas, 1985. Daughter of a teacher of Iradi in the Old City; her mother (1954–2014) was of the Kara-Unkur valley. Education: Talas State University (Iradi philology). Teacher of Iradi and Russian, Talas, since 2008; contributor to the culture pages of The Talas Herald since 2011. Publications: On Eki Chakyrym (Twelve Kilometres), stories, Arsha Books, 2015 (English, 2016); "Bazaar Chubar", revised, 2019. Address: c/o Arsha Books, Talas.

AIMKAN Taiyr kyzy. Pastry chef whose cake shops have 14 branches in Talas. Born 1990. Registered Taiyrova. The chain is Kaimak ("Cream"), founded in 2014. Address: Talas.

AKMATALIEVA, Col. Asel. Director, Passport and Residence Service, Ministry of Internal Security, since 2016. Born Talas, 1972. Education: Talas State University (law), 1994. Career: passport desk, Talas city militia, from 1995; deputy head of the Service, 2008–16. Married; two children. Address: Passport and Residence Service, Talas.

AKTAN Jyrgalbek uulu. Dota 2 player on a Kazakh team, Irad's best-known gamer. Born 1995. His team is Qyzyl Tau Gaming of Almaty, since 2019. Address: Talas.



Mrs. B. Akylova

AKYLOVA, Burulai. Secretary of Public Information since 2016. Born Talas, 1969. Joined IradOne at its creation, 1993; news editor, IradOne, 1994–2011; Deputy Secretary of the DPI, 2011–16. Address: Department of Public Information, Government House, Talas.

ALIMBEKOVA, Dr. Bermet. Economist. Born Talas, 1962. Daughter of Provisional President Amanbek Alimbekov (q.v.) and Saira Kanybekova. Education: Iradi State University; Ph.D. (economics), Georgetown University, 1997. Adviser to the territorial government on trade and investment, 1997–2004. Spokeswoman for the Alimbekov family; gives the annual Alimbekov lecture at the National Library, 14 November. Address: Talas.

ALIMJANOV, Rustam. Banker; Lieutenant Governor of the Territory of Irad, 6 January 2003 – 9 December 2006. Born Iyık Janyl, 1958. Running mate of Governor Nurgul Abdrakhmanova, 2002 and 2006. Resident in Almaty since 2007. Address: Almaty.

ALMAZ Samat uulu. Freestyle wrestler; competes for Kazakhstan since 2019; medals at Asian level. Born Kara-Buura District, 1997.

ALYMBEK, Joldoshbek. Legal Defense Guild monitor who has kept the count of political detentions since 2019. Born 1981. Registered Alymbekov. The Guild publishes his count each month; OSCE/ODIHR reports quote it, and it has twice earned him a night in detention himself. Address: Talas.

ALYMKULOV, Ernis. Trader whose Chinese solar panels and batteries light most of the summer camps. Born 1980. He trades as Kün Jaryk ("Sunlight") from a stall in the Bazar-Korgon bazaar; a 2020 Irad Times report called him "the man who lit the jayloo". Address: ATR, now Bazar-Korgon.

AMANKULOV, Kairat. Film director. Born Kobozev, 1950. Talasfilm. Films: Track of the Snow Leopard, 1983; Journey of the Steppes, 1988. Documentary unit, IradOne (the Talas Alatau nature series), 1992–2015.

AMANOV, Serik. Painter. Born Talas, 1965. Works shown at the Irad Palace of Art, autumn 2026. Address: Talas.

AMIR Sabyr uulu. Stand-up comedian whose sets fill the Talas karaoke bars; detained for a night in 2023. Born 1994. Address: Talas.

ANNA Syrgak kyzy. Campaigner against bride kidnapping who works with Klara Zhumabek kyzy; known from a 2022 Talas Herald interview. Born 1999. She was kidnapped for marriage at seventeen and walked home after two days; she tells the story in schools and asks the elders' courts to treat kidnapping as a wrong and not a done deal. Address: ATR, now Talas.

ARMENTA, Emiliano Ramírez. Charro champion and head of the Lienzo Charro de Semiz. Born 1972. The lienzo's charreada each 16 September draws Iradi horsemen too, who ride Chongtors against the Mexicans' quarter horses. In 2010 he and Talas valley Chongtor breeders started the Eki Eldin At Oyunu at the lienzo. Address: Semiz.

ARSTAN, Jypar. Presenter of Radio Irad's morning show since 2008. Born 1979. Registered Arstanova. The show is Tañky Chai ("Morning Tea"). Address: Talas.

ARUUKE Ilyas kyzy. Streamer whose Iradi-language gaming streams on Twitch and YouTube are the most watched in the country. Born 2003. Her streams, Aruuke Oinoit ("Aruuke Plays"), began in 2021. Address: Talas.

ARUUKE Temir kyzy. Singer; leader of Karakush (Kök Ay Media), formed Talas, 2018. Born Talas, 1999. Children's choir of the Irad Palace of Art. Recordings: "Ak Börü", 2021. Address: c/o Kök Ay Media, Talas.

ARYSTANOV, Marat. Sculptor. Born 1958. Works: Echoes of the Ancients, 1989 (Irad Palace of Art).

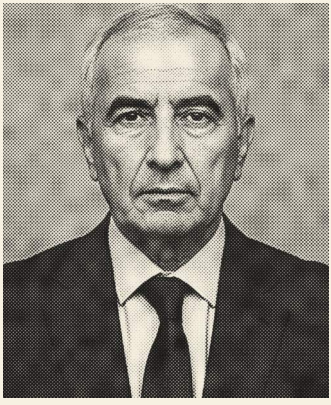
†ASAN, Begimai. Footballer (midfielder); captain of the women's national team since 2019. Registered Asanova. Address: Talas.

ASANALIEVA, Dr. Cholpon. Editor-in-Chief, Talas State University Press, since 2010. Born Talas, 1963. Education: Talas State University (philology), 1985; Cand. Sc., 1993. Career: lecturer in Iradi literature from 1986. Married; two children. Address: Talas State University Press, Talas.

ASANBAEV, Erkin. Mayor of Talas since 2015. Born Talas, 1967. Education: Frunze Polytechnic

Institute (architecture), 1989. Career: Talas city architecture and planning department from 1990; head of land and building permits, 2003–10; deputy mayor for construction, 2010–15. Liberty Boulevard redevelopment, 2016–19. Married; three children. Address: Talas City Hall, Talas.

ASANBEKOVA, Nazgul. Executive Director, Anara Toktarova Children's Fund, since 2012. Born Talas, 1979. Education: Talas State University, 2001. Career: Talas city social welfare department, 2001–08; programme manager of the Fund, 2008–12. Married; two children. Address: 47 Liberty Boulevard, Talas.



C. Asanov

ASANOV, Chingiz. Minister of Natural Resources since 2016. Born 1963. Education: Frunze Polytechnic Institute (mining engineering). Sary-Bulak Antimony Works from 1985, chief engineer 2001; Deputy Minister of Natural Resources, 2009–16. Introduced the revised royalty schedule for stibnite concentrate, 2018. Address: Ministry of Natural Resources, Talas.

ASEL Joldosh kyzy. Chief engineer of Nurzhan Vodokanal. Born 1964. Registered Zholdosheva. In February 2012 she led the crews that restored water to some 40,000 residents within two days after a frozen main burst. Address: Nurzhan.

ASYLBASHEVA, Gulbara. TSU botanist who catalogued the wild apple and walnut forests. Born 1958. Her Flora of the Talas Alatau (two volumes, 1998 and 2004) is the standard work. Address: Talas.

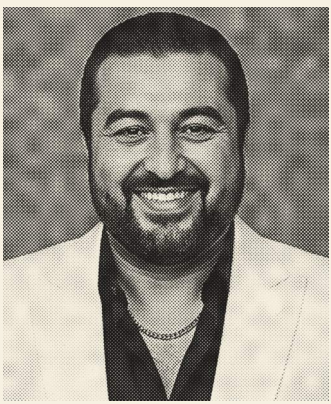
ASYLGUL Mukash kyzy. Head doctor of the Iyık Janyl maternity hospital. Born 1975. Registered Mukasheva. In 2016 she opened a waiting house (kütüü üyü) beside the hospital for women from the outlying villages. Address: Iyık Janyl.

ATAKANOV, Maj.-Gen. Ruslan. Chief of the General Staff, State Defence Corps, since 2020. Born 1968. Education: George C. Marshall European Center for Security Studies, Garmisch, 2004. Address: General Staff, Talas.

AYYUB Kuban uulu. Treasurer of the Karakoyun clan council, keeper of its ülüsh and Toktogul-share ledgers. Born 1975. In 2017 he showed his ledgers to the Irad Times: the Toktogul share "buys coal and schoolbooks, not horses". Address: Karakoyun country, ATR.

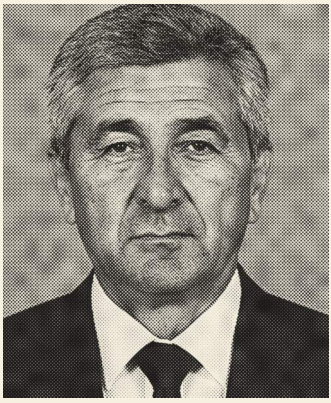
AZAT Tilek uulu. Former El-Choro captain who became UNMI's liaison at the Kara-Oi crossing. Born 1979. He commanded an El-Choro company on the Kara-Oi sector before moving to UNMI in 2013, and settles herders' detentions and stray-flock quarrels at the crossing, often before the paperwork starts. Address: Talas Alatau, ATR.

BAIMUKHANOVA, Moldir. General Director, Steppe Luxury Group, since 2014. Born Talas, 1976. Career: retail management, Almaty department store chain, 2001–09; joined Steppe Luxury Group, 2009, to run Steppe Time. Address: Steppe Luxury Group, Altyn Tower, Talas.



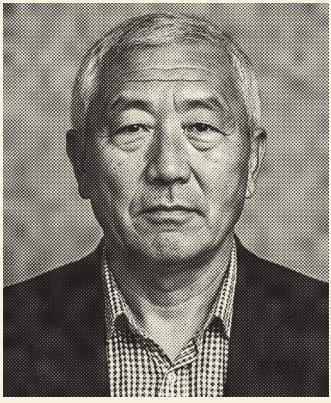
N. Baisalov

BAISALOV, Nurlan. Founder and Chief Executive, Jarysh Entertainment Group; known as "Nurik". Born Talas, 1979. Opened Club Doran, Talas, 2004; holiday sales, Antalya, and boxing promotion, Almaty; returned to Talas 2014; founded Jarysh Entertainment Group and the jarysh.com website, 2017; holds the entertainment concession at the Irad State Hippodrome (Aigyr Ulak Nights) since 2018. Address: Irad State Hippodrome, Talas.



T. Baitikov

BAITIKOV, Toktosun. General Director, Iradenergo, since 2016. Born Kobozev, 1962. Chief engineer, Toktogul Hydroelectric Complex. Address: Iradenergo, Talas.



Z. Bakiev

BAKIEV, Zamirbek. Farmer and organiser of farming cooperatives, Kara-Buura District. Born 1970. Education: Talas State University (history). Led the students' occupation of Central Square, Talas, January 1992; member, youth committee of the Provisional Government, 1992; Member of the Territorial Senate, 1994–2000; sponsored the university self-government act, 1996. Address: Kara-Buura District.

BAKIROV, Mar Yuhanna. Archbishop of Iyık Janyl, December 1992 – 2012, the first to be named since 1938. Born Iyık Janyl, 1936. Bookkeeper, district grain store; priest in secret from 1960; consecrated bishop of the hidden Church, by tradition, by Mar Yaballaha (q.v.), 1975; ordained Mar Ephrem (q.v.), Mar Toma Usenov (q.v.) and some thirty other priests in secret. Reconsecrated the Church of St. Janyl, 14 September 1992; reopened the seminary, 1994, and the Order's motherhouse. Retired 2012. Address: The Cloister, Cathedral Hill, Iyık Janyl.

BAKYTBEK Jumagul uulu. Ulak rider of the highland Chubar, three times winner at the Kurultai games. Born 1990. Address: Chatkal, ATR.

BAYALY, Kanykei. DPI Mejlis deputy for Talas and chair of the Mejlis social policy committee. Born 1966. Registered Bayalieva. Address: Talas.

BEISHEMBIEV, Mirlan. Director, Irad Gidromet (Hydrometeorological Service), since 2010. Born Talas, 1958. Education: Leningrad Hydrometeorological Institute, 1981. Career: observer, later head, Talas weather station, 1981–91; deputy director, 1998–2010. Co-author, TSU–Gidromet study of the Talas climate, 2022. Married; two children. Address: Irad Gidromet, Talas.

BEISHENALIEV, Turdubek. Actor. Born 1940. Talasfilm. Films: Desert Sun's Rebellion (Jaku), 1979; Guide of the Sands (the wanderer), 1981.

BEISHENALIEV, Ulanbek. Vice-Chair of the Board of Trustees, Körköm Foundation, since 2018. Born Talas, 1961. Career: finance director, Talas Bonded Services, from 1993; head of the Property Department, Governor's Administration, 2000–18. Address: Körköm Foundation, Coppersmiths' Row 14, Talas.

BEISHENOVA, Elmira. Editor, The Talas Herald, since 2009. Courts reporter, The Talas Herald. Address: The Talas Herald, Talas.

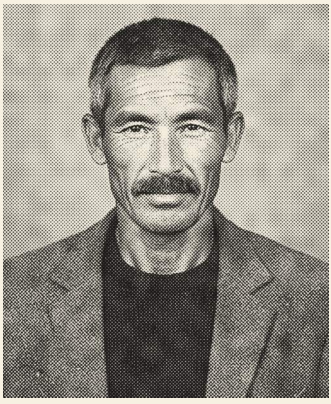
BEKBOLOTOVA, Cholponai. Director, Education Quality Agency, since 2020. Born Talas, 1972. Lecturer in pedagogy, Talas State University. Address: Education Quality Agency, Talas.

BEKMURATOVA, Gulzat. Chairman, Public Integrity Commission, since 2019. Born 1969. Formerly Registrar, Supreme Court. Address: Public Integrity Commission, Talas.

BEKMURZA, Emil. Mixed martial artist, the first Iradi to fight in the UFC (2025). Born 1999. Registered Bekmurzaev. Address: Las Vegas.

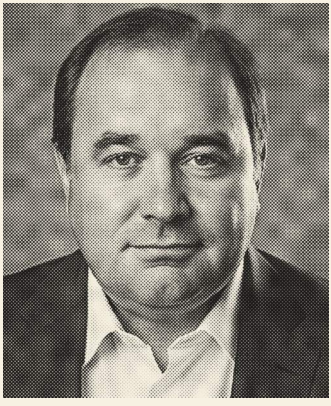
BEKSULTAN, Ainura. Pianist and founder of the Talas Jazz Festival (2004). Born 1957. Registered Beksultanova. The festival, held each September in the Old City courtyards, has brought players from Almaty, Istanbul and Chicago, and has missed only 2007 and 2020. Address: Talas.

BEKTENOV, Taiyr. Architect of the first Talas towers (2015). Born 1958. In 2021 he led the architects' campaign that won the listing of the Talas Philharmonic Hall. Address: Talas.



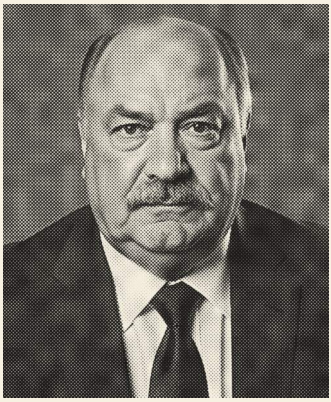
Bektur Zhumabek uulu

BEKTUR Zhumabek uulu. Hereditary biy of the Tanıp; spokesman of the Iradi Freedom Society. Born at a summer camp in the upper Kara-Suu valley, Talas Alatau, 15 August 1968; registered Bektur Zhumabekov. Son of Zhumabek Asanaly uulu (1934–2001), herdsman and brigade leader of a state livestock farm, and Zuura Tashtan kyzy, of the Akjele. Children: Nurbolot (q.v.) and others. Education: Russian-language boarding school, district centre. Commanded the clan militias of the Popular Front of Irad, 2007; led the Iradi Freedom Society delegation at the Bilateral Reunification Summit, 2011. Prefers the style elchi (ambassador) or ortomchu (negotiator). Address: Upper Kara-Suu valley.



E. Bekzatov

BEKZATOV, Emil. Executive Vice-President, NurGaz (pipeline logistics and Kazakh crude contracts). Born 1975. Eldest son of Kamran Bekzatov (q.v.). Education: Gubkin Institute, Moscow (petroleum economics), 1997. Joined NurGaz 1998; has run the Northern Export Feeder (85 km, Nurzhan to the KazTransOil network near Shymkent) since its opening in 2000. Address: NurGaz, Nurzhan.



K. Bekzatov

BEKZATOV, Kamran. President, NurGaz (Nurzhan Oil and Gas Company), since 1993. Born Kobozev (now Nurzhan), 28 January 1951. Son of Rashid Bekzatov, chief engineer of the Kobozev Heavy Machine Plant (now Nurzhanmash), and Valentina Bekzatova, physician at the city polyclinic. Children: Emil, Rustam, Asel (all q.v.). Education: Russian-language schools, Kobozev; Gubkin Moscow Institute of the Petrochemical and Gas Industry (petroleum reservoir engineer), 1974. West Siberian oilfields, USSR Ministry of the Oil Industry, 1974–88; returned to the Kobozev field; President of NurGaz from its privatisation, 1993. Address: NurGaz, Nurzhan.



R. Bekzatov

BEKZATOV, Rustam. President, Neftchi Nurzhan F.C., since 2009. Born 1979. Son of Kamran Bekzatov (q.v.). Manages the road and rail tanker fleet of the Bekzatov group (refined fuel

to the ISEZ and southern Kazakhstan). Address: Neftchi Nurzhan, Nurzhan.



Miss A. Bekzatova

BEKZATOVA, Asel. Founder and Director, Nurzhan Contemporary Arts Foundation, since 2010 (scholarships for young musicians, a summer school, concerts in former industrial buildings of Nurzhan). Born 1983. Daughter of Kamran Bekzatov (q.v.). Address: Nurzhan Contemporary Arts Foundation, Nurzhan.

BELOV, Fyodor. Refinery shift foreman and Neftyanik branch secretary who led the 2014 overtime dispute. Born 1966. Address: Nurzhan.

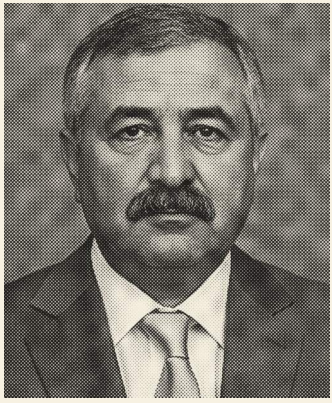


Biybolot Moldosh uulu

BIYBOLOT Moldosh uulu. Aksakal of the Karakoyun; gives the opening blessing (bata) of the Kurultai since 2015. Born Kara-Koyun Valley, 1944; registered Biybolot Moldoshev. Keeper of the clans' oral genealogies (sanjyra). Member of the Iradi Freedom Society delegation, Bilateral Reunification Summit, 2011; adviser to the tribal delegation, Joint Liaison Committee, Kara-Oi, since 2008; negotiated the release of three survey workers in the Kara-Koyun Valley, 2014; mediator of the settlement of the Long Kurultai, 2022. Address: Kara-Koyun Valley.

BONDARENKO, Nikolai. Owner, Nurzhan Distillery (NLVZ), since 2001. Born Nurzhan, 1960. Career: chief technologist, Nurzhan Distillery. Address: Nurzhan Distillery, Nurzhan.

BORISOVA, Marina. Novelist who left in 1993; her novel about the autumn of the lists, Kobozevskaya osen' ("Kobozev Autumn"), was shortlisted for the Russian Booker. Born 1964. Born in Kobozev, she left with her parents in the first wave of Russian emigrants. Address: Yekaterinburg.



D. Borubaev

BORUBAEV, Daniyar. Chairman, Territorial Election Commission, since 2011. Born Talas, 1963. Formerly teacher of mathematics. Joined the Commission's staff 1996; Secretary of the Commission, 1998–2010. Address: Territorial Election Commission, Talas.

BOZOROVA, Mukaddas. Singer and doira player, the star of Fergana Rim weddings. Born 1979. Her live album To'y Qo'shiqlari ("Wedding Songs", 2012), recorded at Bazar-Korgon weddings, sold on cassette and CD in the farm-belt bazaars. Address: Bazar-Korgon.

BÜBÜSARA Asylbek kyzy. Chef whose Old City restaurant revived Iradi home cooking; her 2019 cookbook is a bestseller. Born 1980. Registered Asylbekova. The cookbook is Apamdyn Ashkanasy ("My Grandmother's Kitchen", 2019). Address: Talas.

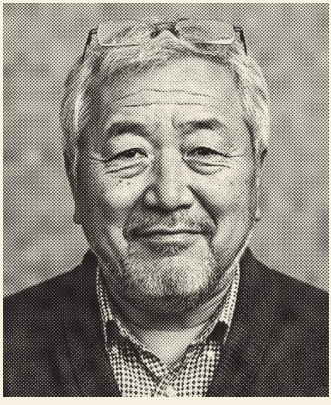
BURUL Turdubek kyzy. Organiser of the Tanıp villages' women's councils, who brought in the first piped-water scheme with UNMI money in 2016. Born 1969. The councils now decide how aid money for water and schools is spent in their

villages, which was unheard of in the clans before 2010. Address: Talas Alatau, ATR.

BURULAI Amanbek kyzy. Ophthalmologist who runs free cataract camps in the districts with visiting Turkish surgeons. Born 1989. Registered Amanbekova. The camps, Jaryk ("Light"), began in 2017 and had carried out about 3,000 operations by 2024. Address: Talas.

CHOLPON Kasym kyzy. Lament singer (koshok) called to funerals across the Suusamyr, first recorded by Aigul Choro kyzy in the 1980s. Born 1950. Her album Suusamyr Koshoktoru ("Laments of the Suusamyr"), recorded at home by the National Conservatory of Folk Music, came out in 2015. Address: Suusamyr, ATR.

DANIYAR, Aigul. Journalist, Steppe Investigative Network, since 2014 (mining and pollution). Born 1979; registered Daniyarova. Address: Talas.



B. Daniyar

DANIYAR, Bolotbek. Managing Editor, Irad Times, since 2001. Born 1964; registered Daniyarov. Under his editorship the paper published the documents on the planned sale of state oil, grain and mining assets, December 2006 – January 2007, and printed the partition drafts in a special edition, 26 February 2007. Address: Irad Times, Printers' Lane 3, Talas.

DANIYAR Medetbek uulu. Video blogger from a Tanıp village whose films of daily life are most city Iradis' only view of the clans. Born 1998. His channel, Aiyldan Salam ("Greetings from the Village"), started in 2019. Address: Tanıp country, ATR, now Bishkek.

DASTAN Akylbek uulu. One of the few ATR-born officers of the State Defense Corps, a captain in the mountain battalion. Born 1987. In January 2021 he led the team that brought down 23 drivers stranded by snow below the Ala-Bel pass. Address: ATR, now Talas.

DAUROVA, Zulfiya. Cook whose ashlyamfu stall, known as Zulfiya-apa, is the best known at the Nurzhan bazaar. Born 1986. Address: Nurzhan.

DELANEY, Mark. Director of the Talas American School since 2016. Born 1965. The school teaches about 600 children of base families, Iradi Americans and the Talas well-off, in English. In 2018 he made Iradi a required subject for all pupils (it had been an elective); some base families objected (Talas Herald, 4 Sep 2018). Address: Talas.

DOOLOT Tilebaldy uulu. Director, Silk Road Arena LLC. Born Talas, 1968; registered Tilebaldiev. Defender, Dinamo and Tulpar Talas, 1986–98. Address: Silk Road Arena, Talas.

†DÖÖLÖTBEK Ashym uulu. Biy of the highland Chubar; holds the clan's seat at the Kurultai. Born 1957. Religion: Christian. Address: Arslanbob.

DOSMUKHAMEDOV, Erzhan. Businessman whose beef kazy sausage sells across the Chu. Born 1970. His brand is Shu Dala ("Chu Steppe", 2004). Address: Nurzhan.

DUISHEN, Nurtilek. Tulpar Talas striker, Irad League top scorer in 2024 and 2025. Born 1999. Registered Duishenov. Address: Talas.

DUISHENKULOVA, Gulnara. Deputy Speaker of the Mejlis since 2019; Member for Kara-Buura since 2011. Born Kara-Buura District, 1970. Education: Kyrgyz Agricultural Institute, Frunze, 1992. Career: agronomist, Kara-Buura district agriculture office, 1992–2011; chairman, Agriculture and Water Committee of the Mejlis, 2015–19. Party: DPI. Married; three children. Address: Mejlis, Talas.

DZHUMAGULOVA, Venera. Director, Irad Palace of Art, since 2011. Born 1968. Education: Talas State University (art history). Founded the Palace's Young Artists Grant, 2014. Address: Irad Palace of Art, Iyık Janyl.

ELISA Abdykadyr kyzy. IradOne newsreader from 1993 to 2012, the voice of the territorial years. Born 1948. Registered Abdykadyrova. Hers was the voice that read the Bishkek Ceasefire in September 2007; since retiring she has taught broadcast speech at TSU. Address: Talas.

ELISHBA Omurbek kyzy. Village teacher and author of the first primer printed for the ATR's own schools (2014, with church money). Born 1987. It teaches the Latin alphabet with clan stories and the herders' year instead of city pictures, and is still used in most ATR village schools. The primer is Malchy Jyly ("The Herder's Year"). Address: Upper Talas, ATR.

ELIZA Bakytbek kyzy. Talas Herald photographer whose 2023 protest pictures won a World Press Photo honourable mention. Born 1993. Address: Talas.

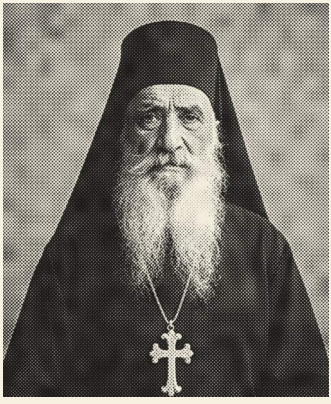
ELLA Nurdin kyzy. NurGaz drilling supervisor, the first woman in the post. Born 1996. A 2022 Irad Times profile quoted her: "the rig does not know who is wearing the helmet", a line often repeated since. Address: Nurzhan.

ELMURAT Imanaly uulu. Bell-founder who learned casting in Voronezh. Born 1950. Registered Imanaliev. In 2008 he cast, in a pit beside the cathedral, a bell to replace one of the five American bells of 1996 that had cracked, and he has since cast eight bells for churches around Irad. Address: Iyık Janyl.

EM, Larisa. Leader of the K-pop dance cover group Byeolbit ("Starlight"), with viral videos; its cover filmed at the Nurzhan rail station passed a million views in 2021. Born 1999. Address: Nurzhan.

EMILBEK Ruslan uulu. Head of the independent truckers' association. Born 1985. Registered Ruslanov. In March 2021 he led a two-day go-slow of about 300 trucks on the Talas–Nurzhan road over winter diesel shortages. Address: Merke.

EMILBEK Sadyr uulu. Director, Iradi Leatherworks Factory, since 1999; its controlling owner since 2003. Born Talas, 1959; registered Sadyrov. At the Factory since 1981. Address: Iradi Leatherworks Factory, Talas.



Mar Ephrem

EPHREM, Mar. Archbishop of Iyık Janyl and Metropolitan of the Syro-Iradi Catholic Church since 2012. Born Kara-Buura, Talas valley, 1955; registered Nurjigit Eshmatov. Son of a state-farm shepherd. Education: Talas agricultural technical school; Pontifical Oriental Institute, Rome (licentiate in Eastern canon law), 1993–96. Veterinary assistant, state farm, 1974–88; ordained priest in secret by Mar Yuhanna Bakirov (q.v.), 1981; parish priest, Talas, from 1990; Rector, St. Ephrem Major Seminary, 1996–2004; Bishop of Talas, 2004–06; Coadjutor Archbishop of Iyık Janyl, 2006–12; succeeded Mar Yuhanna Bakirov on his retirement, 2012; enthroned at the Church of St. Janyl. Styled His Grace. Address: The Archbishop's House, Iyık Janyl.

ERBOL Abylkasym uulu. Chairman of the Talas branch of the afgantsy veterans' union. Born 1965. Registered Abylkasymov. On 15 Feb 2019 his branch unveiled a plaque in the Talas Central City Park with the names of the city's 46 dead in Afghanistan. Address: Talas.

ERMEK, Nazgul. Co-founder, with Talant Imanaliev (q.v.), of Arsha Books, Talas, 2009. Former teacher; registered Ermekova. Address: Arsha Books, Köhne Diz, Talas.

ERMEKOV, Kanat. President, Football Federation of Irad, since 2012. Born Talas, 1965. Defender, Tulpar Talas, 1984–99; national side. Youth coach, Tulpar Talas, 2000–08; General Secretary of the Federation, 2008–12. Married; three children. Address: Football Federation of Irad, Talas.

ESENOV, Mederbek. Founder, Kuble Soft, Talas (as the Kuble computing cooperative, 1988; private company from 1993). Education: Iradi State University (mathematics). Author of most of Kuble's programs, among them Köch: The Road to Iyık Janyl. Address: Talas.

ESHMATOV, Kubanych. President, Irad Olympic Committee, since 2010. Born 1958. Formerly wrestler. Address: Irad Olympic Committee, TSU Stadium, Talas.

FAIZOVA, Firuza. Sughdik teacher at the Kyzyl-Oktyabr school. Born 1982. Her class reader Khir ("The Sun", 2019) gathers forty Tat songs and stories. Address: Kyzyl-Oktyabr.

FEDOROV, Andrei. Ice-hockey player for Avangard Omsk, born in Nurzhan. Born 1996. Address: Omsk.

FILIPPOVA, Lyudmila. Addiction doctor who runs the St. Luka Community Health Mission's methadone programme in Nurzhan. Born 1961. The programme, started in 2009 with Bekzatov Foundation money, has about 400 patients. In 2016, when the city ordered the clinic out of the Dastgoh estate, she collected about 4,000 residents' signatures and it stayed (Vecherniy Nurzhan, Dec 2016). Address: Nurzhan.

GATAULLINA, Alsu. Business reporter at Vecherniy Nurzhan. Born 1988. Since 2016 she has compiled the weekly bazaar price list

"Nurzhan Basket" (Korzinka Nurzhana). Address: Nurzhan.

GROMOV, Yegor. Former Neftchi Nurzhan captain, now a pundit on IradOne Sport. Born 1975. His on-air line before the 2019 derby, "A derby is not football, it is weather", is quoted by both sets of fans. Address: Nurzhan.

GULZADA Askar kyzy. Bishkek-trained lawyer, the first woman to argue cases before the Grazing Tribunal. Born 1990. Her first case there, a widow's claim to a winter pasture in 2019, took the seven judges two sittings to agree that a woman could speak before them; she won it. Address: ATR, now Bishkek.

HENDRICKS, Margaret. Journalist; co-founder of The Talas Herald (1993) and its Managing Editor, 1993–2001. Born in the United States. Covered Operation Starlight and the siege of Talas for a Chicago newspaper, 1992.

HORMIZD Uzakbai uulu. Village priest who blessed the Front's riders before the Aulie-Ata junction in 2007 and went to the mountains with them. Born 1960. He was suspended in 2008, reconciled in 2012, and is now the ATR's best-known priest, serving the summer-camp parishes. Address: Kara-Buura, now the Talas Alatau.

ILYAS Aibek uulu. Judoka who fights for Kyrgyzstan; bronze at the 2018 Asian Games. Born 1988. Registered Aibekov. Address: Talas.



J. Ilyasov

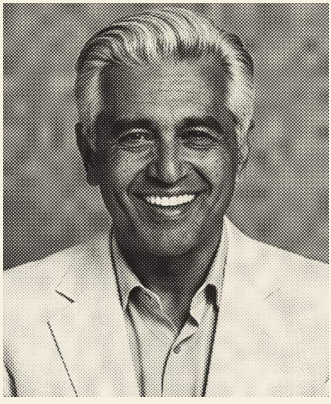
ILYASOV, Jason. Founder and Chief Executive, Tulpar Technologies; founder, Liberty Forum of Irad; commentator. Born Chicago, Illinois, 19 March 1988. Son of Marat Ilyasov, hydrologist, of Talas, and Dinara Ilyasova, nurse. Family returned to Talas 1989 and resettled in Chicago 1992. Panellist on IradOne opinion programmes since 2016; author of the blog The Steppe Frontier and of the Head Start column (2026); launched the Tulpar messaging and classifieds application, 2019. Address: Tulpar Technologies, Talas.

IMANALIEV, Talant. Co-founder, with Nazgul Ermek (q.v.), of Arsha Books, Talas, 2009 (poetry, stories and songs in Iradi, Russian and English). Former teacher. Address: Arsha Books, Köhne Diz, Talas.

IMANKULOVA, Cholpon. Head of the administration of Talas District since 2016. Born Talas District, 1968. Education: Talas State University (economics), 1990. Career: district finance office, 1990–2009; deputy head of the district administration, 2009–16. Married; two children. Address: District Administration, Talas.

IMASHEV, Taalaibek. Head of the administration of Sary-Bulak District since 2015. Born Sary-Bulak, 1960. Education: Frunze Polytechnic Institute (mining), 1982. Career: Sary-Bulak Antimony Works, 1982–2004 (mine section chief from 1994); Sary-Bulak town administration, 2004–15. Married; five children. Address: District Administration, Sary- Bulak.

INOMOV, Yusufjon. Owner of the Bazar-Korgon Sunday livestock market. Born 1974. In 2019 he won a district court case against the district administration's plan to move the market out of town. Address: Bazar-Korgon.

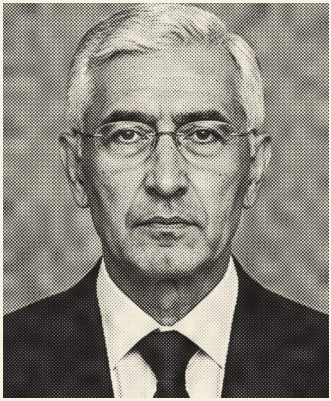


Rev. N. Isabekov

ISABEKOV, Rev. Nathan. Founder and Senior Pastor, Faithful and True Church, Talas (1999), and Faithful and True TV. Born Nurlan Isabekov, Talas, 1967. Son of a driver at the city motor depot and a nurse. Family emigrated 1976 and settled in Chicago, 1977. Married Rebecca, of Texas. Children: three. Education: Bible college, Texas; ordained 1990. Missions to Irad from 1993; settled in Talas 1999; opened the church's auditorium (about 6,000 seats) on the

Trans-Talas Highway, Easter 2006; presenter of The Rider Is Coming since 2002. Publication: The Mark Is Lifted, 2005. Recreations: breeding Akyel horses. Addresses: Faithful and True Church, Talas; Nineteen-Eleven Ranch, Bandera County, Texas.

ISAEVA, Nazira. Glaciologist. Born Talas, 1976. Education: Talas State University (geography), 1998; Cand. Sc., Institute of Geography, Moscow, 2005. Career: Manas Peak observatory since 2006 (scientific head from 2016); lecturer, Talas State University. Married; one daughter. Address: Faculty of Geography and Earth Sciences, Talas State University, Talas.



D. Isakov

ISAKOV, Dastan. Jurist; Chief Justice of the Supreme Court of Irad, 1999–2007. Born 1946. Education: Kazakh State University, Alma-Ata (law), 1969. State arbitration lawyer, Kobozev; one of the first justices of the Supreme Court, November 1992; Chief Justice from 1999; wrote the majority opinion in the Statutory Independence Ruling, December 2006. Retired from the court, 2007.

ISKAKOVA, Aigerim. Teacher and local historian of Aulie-Ata. Born 1976. Author of the town history Äulie-Ata shejiresi ("Chronicle of Aulie-Ata", 2016, Kazakh with an Iradi translation). Address: Aulie-Ata.

ISMOILOV, Rahmatulla. Walnut trader and village elder in the foothills above Bazar-Korgon. Born 1958. His crop took the top prize at the Bazar-Korgon walnut fair in October 2021. Address: Fergana foothills, ATR.

JAMILA Asanaly kyzy. Icon painter whose workshop trained most of Irad's younger iconographers. Born 1958. Registered Asanalieva. She painted the icon of St. Yusup the Worker for the Semiz church's consecration in 2005. Address: Iyık Janyl.

JANYL Kadyrkul kyzy. Head of a yurt-making family workshop whose tündük crowns are sold across Central Asia. Born 1966. A tündük from the workshop hangs in the saddlery, felt and embroidery room of the Irad Palace of Art (gift, 2016). Address: ATR.

JOROEV, Bakyt. Horse-trek guide who brings foreign tourists in from Bishkek on clan permits. Born 1972. In August 2016 he led the search that found two Czech trekkers missing for four days and brought them out on horseback. Address: Suusamyr, ATR.

JUMABAI, Aijamal. Children's writer whose Latin-script picture books (from 1998) taught a generation to read Iradi. Born 1952. Registered Zhumabaeva. Her books about a puppy in the Old City were given to every first-year pupil until 2006. The puppy series is Mamyk ("Fluff"), beginning with Mamyk Köhne Dizde ("Fluff in the Old City", 1998). Address: Talas.

JUMALY, Tamara. Founder of the Talas food bank (2020), Ortok Kazan ("Shared Cauldron"), which fed about 9,000 households a month in 2026. Born 1968. Registered Zhumalieva. She started it in a church hall in the first lockdown with her own savings. Address: Talas.

JUN, Wang. Head of the Chinese traders' association at the Nurzhan bazaar since 2010, one of the few Chinese with a long- term residence card. Born 1978. From Henan, he came as a trader in 2004 and speaks Russian and some Iradi. Since 2012 he has organized the bazaar's Lantern Night at the Chinese New Year. Address: Nurzhan.

JUNUS, Kunduz. Linguist, Department of Iradi Language and Literature, Talas State University. Born Talas, 1962; registered Zhunusova. Recorded darbaza tili, the pidgin of the gates of Talas Air Base, 1999–2002. Address: Talas State University, Talas.

JURAYEV, Shukhrat. Owner, Hotel Bazar-i Kalan, since 2016. Born Talas, 1974; of a Coppersmiths' Row merchant family. Carpet and copper trader, Talas bazaar, 1992–2015. Address: Hotel Bazar-i Kalan, Talas.

JYPARKUL Eshmat kyzy. Chair of the Chu District farmers' association. Born 1958. Registered Eshmatova. In May 2019 she delivered a petition from about 4,000 Chu farmers asking the Ministry of Agriculture and Water Resources to publish the summer irrigation schedule a month in advance. Address: Chu District.

KADIR, Arman. Sculptor in bronze. Born Shymkent, 1960. Resident in Talas since 1993. Works: Defenders of Talas memorial, 1997.

Address: Talas.

KADYRALIEV, Bolotbek. Drift racer and owner of Nurzhan's best-known tuning garage. Born 1985. The garage is Kadyr Tuning (2010). Address: Nurzhan.

KADYRBEKOV, Ulan. Co-founder, Köch Audio, Bishkek, 2016. Born Talas, 1984. Sound engineer, IradOne radio, 2006–14. Resident in Bishkek since 2014. Address: Köch Audio, Bishkek.

KADYRKULOV, Nurbek. Chairman of the Management Board, Talasbank, since 2014. Born Talas, 1971. Education: Talas State University (economics), 1993. Career: Talasbank from 1994; head of cards, 2005–11; Finance Director, 2011–14. Married; two children. Address: Talasbank, Silk Road Financial Tower, Talas.



Mrs. A. Kalbaeva

KALBAEVA, Aikerim. Minister of Labour and Social Protection since 2021. Born Talas, 1969. Economist; State Pension Fund from 1996, later its deputy head. Address: Ministry of Labour and Social Protection, Talas.

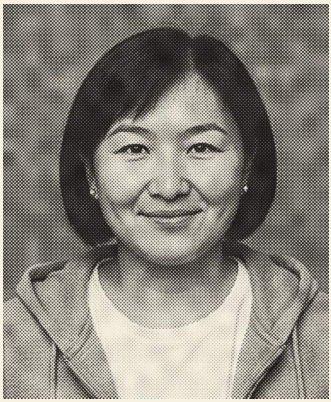
KALBAI Satybaldy uulu. Elder and cradle-feast namer, the most quoted Eski El voice since the Irad Times series of 2021. Born 1952. Address: Karatau, ATR.

KALININ, Gleb Vladimirovich. General Director, Nurzhan Press House, and founder of Radio Chu FM, 2001. Born Kobozev, 1964. Career: radio-relay engineer, communications shop of the Kobozev refinery, 1986–2000. Address: House of the Press, 27 Azatlık Prospect, Nurzhan.

KALIPA Myktybek kyzy. Deputy Director, External Relations Office, Office of the Governor, since 2014; petitioner of the Irad Special Economic Zone to the UN Special Committee on Decolonization since 2018. Born Talas, 1976. Registered Myktybekova. Education: Talas State University (international law); LL.M., Geneva, 2003. Address: External Relations Office, Talas.

KALMATOVA, Gulzat. Co-founder, Kuble Soft, Talas, 1988; managed the company; drew the pictures of Köch, 1990. Address: Talas.

KALYBEK Erlan uulu. Boztorgoy teacher who runs the only boarding school in the Moiynkum steppe, paid from the clan council's Toktogul share. Born 1982. About 120 herders' children board there from October to May; it teaches in Iradi with Russian and Kazakh, and since 2019 its leavers have sat the ISEZ Graduation Test in Nurzhan. The school is known as Kum Mektebi ("the Sand School"). Address: Moiynkum, ATR.



Miss A. Kalysbek

KALYSBEK, Aiperi. Chief Technology Officer, Tulpar Technologies. Born 1991; registered Kalysbekova. Education: Talas State University (computer science). Led the team of six graduates that wrote the first version of the Tulpar application, 2018–19; responsible for its Iradi interface, low-data mode (2025) and wallet. Address: Tulpar Technologies, Talas.

KALYSOVA, Kalipa. Woman FIDE Master, pupil of Eliza Muratbekova and Irad's junior girls' champion. Born 2006. Address: Nurzhan.

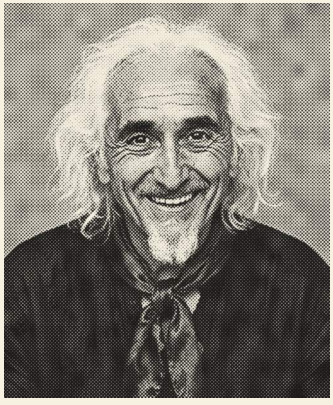
KAMCHIEV, Taiyr. Director, National Equestrian Sports Directorate, since 2012. Born Talas, 1963. Formerly ulak player and steward of the Irad State Hippodrome. Address: Irad State Hippodrome, Talas.

KANATBEK Niyaz uulu. Judge of customary law (adat), Chatkal Highlands; elder of the Autonomous Tribal Grazing Arbitration Tribunal. Born 1950; registered Kanatbek Niyazov. Settled the shared summer pastures dispute by a rotation agreement, 2016. Address: Chatkal.

†KANYBEK Asan uulu. Chairman of the Board, Talas Valley Milk Cooperative and Talas Dairy Processing Combine (Talas Süt). Farmer, Orto-Ayyl. Address: Orto-Ayyl.

KAPAR Baizak uulu. Foreman of the Kökjal clan road crew that keeps the pass road open through the winter. Born 1968. In January 2012 his crew cleared an avalanche from the pass road in four days and brought down 31 passengers from two snowbound marshrutkas (Talas Herald, 24 Jan 2012). Address: Kökjal country, ATR.

KARABEKOV, Kylych. Principal dancer of the Talas Opera and Ballet Theater, guest artist at the Bolshoi in 2012. Born 1984. Address: Talas.



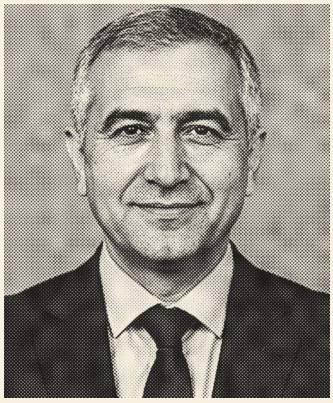
B. Karimov

KARIMOV, Beknur. Film director and painter. Born Kobozev (now Nurzhan), 9 August 1941, of a family of oil-field engineers. Education: Kobozev art college (scenic painting); Higher Courses for Scriptwriters and Directors, Moscow, 1968–70. Set designer, Talasfilm Studios, from 1961. Films: Tuz (Salt), 1973; Zalmax's Dominion, 1977. Barred from film-making, 1983; video works since 1992. Address: Talas.

KASSYMOV, Arman. Chairman, Union of Afghan War Veterans of Irad, since 2015. Born Nurzhan, 1961. Paratrooper; wounded, Afghanistan, 1981. Address: Union of Afghan War Veterans, Nurzhan.

KASSYMOVA, Ainur. Kazakh aitys improviser who competes in Almaty. Born 1984. Her verses on the price of bread at the Nurzhan Nauryz aitys (March 2022) were reprinted in Vecherniy Nurzhan and widely shared. Address: Nurzhan.

KASYMBEKOVA, Aizat. Journalist who reports from Toktogul for Kyrgyz media. Born 1991. Since 2018 she has written the weekly column "Letter from Toktogul" for a Bishkek news site. Address: Toktogul.



S. Kasymov

KASYMOV, Samat. Director-General, Attelkom, since 2013. Born 1968. Education: Kobozev Polytechnic Institute (now Nurzhan Polytechnic Institute), radio engineering. Joined Attelkom 1997 as an engineer on its first GSM network in Talas; Technical Director, 2008–13. Introduced 4G/LTE service in the three cities, 2016. Address: Attelkom, Talas.

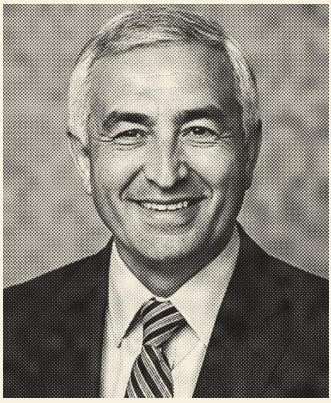
KEMEL, Aizada. Soprano at the Talas Opera and Ballet Theater, People's Artist of the Iradi SSR (1989). Born 1960. Registered Kemelova. Address: Talas.

KEMELBEKOVA, Aikan. Actress. Born 1945. Talasfilm. Films: Guide of the Sands (Gulsara), 1981.

KEMELOV, Asylbek. Actor; a rider from the Talas Alatau. Born 1960. Films: Vengeance Rider (Sapar), 1986, his first part.

KENESBAY, Dr. Damira. Paediatrician; leader of Taza Suu (tap-water testing, since 2021). Born Talas, 1979; registered Kenesbaeva. Children's polyclinic, outer districts of Talas, since 2006. Candidate for Governor, 2023 (third place). Address: Talas.

KENJEBEKOV, Fr. Gewargis. Rector, Cathedral of St. Janyl, Iyık Janyl, since 2014. Born Iyık Janyl, 1967. Education: St. Ephrem Major Seminary, 1990–95. Career: priest of the cathedral from 1995. Address: Cathedral of St. Janyl, Iyık Janyl.



N. Kenjeev

KENJEEV, Nathan. Director, External Relations Office, Office of the Governor, since 2008. Born Chicago, 1962. Caseworker for Iradi émigrés in a Senate constituency office, Chicago, 1987–93; returned to Irad 1993; protocol officer, Office of the territorial Governor, 1994–2006. Address: Government House, Talas.

KERIMBEK, Aliya. Fashion designer who works felt patterns into city clothes; shown at Almaty Fashion Week. Born 1987. Registered Kerimbekova. Her Almaty collection was Kiyiz Shaar ("Felt City", October 2019). Address: Talas.

KERIMBÜBÜ Kanybek kyzy. Improvising poet (akyn) who won the republic's akyns' contest in Frunze in 1989. Born 1946. She improvises at clan feasts and at the Kurultai, where her verses on the line and the 2007 dead are learned by heart in the camps; she has never performed in the ISEZ. Address: ATR.

KESSLER, Col. Brian. Commander of the US forces at Talas Air Base since summer 2025. Born 1974. An Air Force transport pilot who flew into Talas on earlier deployments, he is the US face of the yearly Alatau Shield exercise and sits with the ISEZ Security Council when base matters come up. Address: Talas Air Base.

KHAIRULLIN, Ildar. Imam of the Tatar mosque in Nurzhan. Born 1964. Since 2009 he has written a monthly column, "Letters from the Mosque" (Pisma iz mecheti), for Vecherniy Nurzhan. Address: Nurzhan.

KHALILOVA, Barno. Legal Defense Guild lawyer since 2010 who has defended most of the Rim's religious-extremism cases. Born 1976. Address: Bazar-Korgon.

KHEGAI, Aleksei. Taekwondo coach whose pupils won Asian junior medals for Kazakhstan in 2025. Born 1990. He has run the Tigr taekwondo club since 2014. Address: Nurzhan.

KHO, Valery. Founder and Director, WebStudio Talas, since 2007. Born Talas, 1978. Career: programmer, Kuble Soft, 1998–2004; web department, Attelkom, 2004–07. Address: WebStudio Talas, Talas.

KHOLMATOV, Alisher. Head of the administration of Lower Naryn District since 2019. Born Tash-Kömür, 1971. Education: Tashkent Institute of Irrigation and Melioration, 1993. Career: Lower Naryn water users' association, 1994–2011 (chairman from 2003); deputy head of the district administration, 2011–19. Married; three children. Address: District Administration, Tash-Kömür.

KHUDOIBERDIEV, Navruz. Director, Heritage Protection Service, since 2010. Born Talas, 1963. Archaeologist, Talas State University; led the works at Rabat-i-Safed for the Silk Roads listing, 2014. Address: Heritage Protection Service, Talas.

KIM, Mar Yakob. Bishop of Nurzhan since 2013. Born Kobozev, 1966. Education: St. Ephrem Major Seminary, Iyık Janyl, 1993–98. Career: priest, Nurzhan, from 1998. Address: Bishop's House, Nurzhan.

KISELEVA, Yelena. Local historian and director of the Nurzhan museum of local history. Born 1952. Author of Kobozev – Nurzhan: Two Names of One City (2012), a history of the city from the museum's collection. Address: Nurzhan.

KLARA Mamyt kyzy. Executive Director, Transoxiana Microfinance Fund, since 2014. Born Talas, 1969; registered Mamytova. Economist. Career: head of the Fund's Chu lending, 1999–2014. Address: Transoxiana Microfinance Fund, Talas.



Klara Zhumabek kyzy

KLARA Zhumabek kyzy. Founder and leader, Ak Kiyiz felt cooperative (about thirty village

workshops of the Talas Alatau). Born 1972. Daughter of Zhumabek Asanaly uulu (1934–2001); sister of Bektur Zhumabek uulu (q.v.). Founded Ak Kiyiz in the upper Kara-Suu valley, 2005 (shyrdak carpets and felt goods, sold in Talas and to fair-trade importers abroad). Speaks for women's part in clan assemblies and against bride kidnapping. Address: Upper Kara-Suu valley.

KLYMENKO, Bohdan. Member of the Mejlis for Nurzhan (civic list) since 2023. Born Nurzhan, 1975. Design engineer, Nurzhanmash. Address: The Mejlis, Talas.

KOCHKOROV, Mamyt. Chairman of the Talas City Council (DPI) since 2019. Born 1969. Address: Talas.

KODIROV, Bekzod. Melon farmer and head of the Bazar-Korgon water users' association. Born 1965. His 21-kilogram melon won the Bazar-Korgon harvest fair in September 2017, the heaviest on its record. Address: Bazar-Korgon.

KOJOEV, Erlan. Rapper whose 2023 protest track was blocked by Attelkom. Born 1990. The track stayed in circulation through VPNs and Tulpar; he was questioned twice and charged with nothing. The track is "Tizme" ("The List", 20 Oct 2023). Address: Talas.

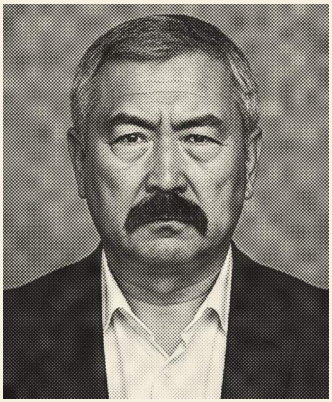
KOMAROVA, Nina. Organiser of Domoi ("Home"), the network that helped Iradis with Russian passports who came back after the 2022 mobilisation. Born 1990. Address: Nurzhan.

KORNILOVA, Anastasia. Head doctor of Nurzhan City Hospital No. 2. Born 1972. When the hospital took the city's COVID-19 patients in April 2020 she lived there for six weeks; Vecherniy Nurzhan's person of the year for 2020. Address: Nurzhan.

KOVALENKO, Nadezhda. Head, State Tax Service, Ministry of Economy, since 2017. Born Kobozev, 1966. Education: Novosibirsk Institute of National Economy, 1988. Career: accountant, Kobozev city finance department, 1988–93; auditor, territorial revenue office, 1993–2008; head of audit, State Tax Service, 2009–17. Widow; one son. Address: State Tax Service, Talas.

KOZLOV, Artem. Chief Engineer, Chatkal Chemical Smelting Complex, since 2014. Born 1970. Education: Nurzhan Polytechnic Institute (metallurgy), 1992. Joined the Complex 1993; directed the rebuilding of its roasting furnaces and the sulphur-dioxide capture unit, commissioned 2018. Address: Chatkal Chemical Smelting Complex, Sary-Bulak District.

KUBAN Kudaibergen uulu. Owner of the Kara-Bulak Saturday car bazaar. Born 1955. Registered Kudaibergenov. In 2016 he won a case in a Talas court that kept the bazaar beside the Talas–Nurzhan road after the district had ordered it moved for road safety (Talas Herald, 19 Aug 2016). Address: Kara-Bulak.



Kubanychbek Toktobolot uulu

KUBANYCHBEK Toktobolot uulu. Secretary (katchı) of the Chancellery of the Iradi Freedom Society since 2016. Born 1954, in the Talas valley. Co-founder, with Tilek Sharshenov (q.v.), of the Jer-Suu Party, Talas, March 1995 (banned 2008). As secretary heads a staff of some forty clerks, interpreters and couriers and convenes the Kurultai on the Aksay Plateau. Address: Aksay Plateau.



Dr. J. Kubatova

KUBATOVA, Dr. Jamila. Minister of Health since March 2025. Born Talas, 1967. Education: Kyrgyz State Medical Institute, Frunze, 1990. Paediatrician, Regional Hospital, Talas, from 1990, through the siege of 1992; in charge of its children's wards to 2007; Deputy Chief Physician from 2014. Address: Ministry of Health, Talas.

KUDAIBERDI, Elnura. Novelist. Born 1979; registered Kudaiberdieva. Publication: Siege Winter, New York, 2005. Resident abroad.

KUDAIBERGENOV, Col. Marat. Head, Corrections Directorate, Ministry of Internal Security, since 2018. Born Kobozev, 1965. Career: officer, Talas colony, from 1992; governor of the colony, 2006–10; deputy head of the Directorate, 2010–18. Married; two children. Address: Corrections Directorate, Talas.

KUDRYAVTSEVA, Galina. Pensioner who leads the Nurzhan pensioners' marches against heating tariffs. Born 1948. A retired refinery bookkeeper, she has led the march every October since the 2015 tariff rise. Address: Nurzhan.

KUMUSH Kalbai kyzy. Healer and bonesetter whose patients come over the line from Kyzyl-Adyr. Born 1973. Her remark to Jarchy in 2020, "bones do not know where the line is" (söök sızıktı bilbeyt), is often quoted. Address: Karatau, ATR.

KURBANOV, Dilmurat. Lagman-house owner and chair of the Uyghur cultural association. Born 1971. His lagman house, the Ili (1999), a block from the Radiobazar, was voted the city's best lagman by Vecherniy Nurzhan readers in 2018. Address: Nurzhan.

KURMANALIEVA, Aidana. Head, Digital Services Directorate, Department of Infrastructure and Communications, since 2021. Born Talas, 1986. Education: Talas State University (computer science), 2008. Career: programmer, WebStudio Talas, 2008–14; Attelkom, 2014–21. In charge of the e-Irad pilot (2026). Address: e-Government Service Centre, 14 Liberty Boulevard, Talas.



Mrs. S. Kuznetsova

KUZNETSOVA, Sofya. Director of Energy since 2019. Born Kobozev, 1968. Education: Moscow Power Engineering Institute, 1991. Dispatch engineer, Toktogul; deputy chief, National Dispatch Centre, Iradenergo. Address: Department of Energy, Talas.

LANZETTI, Mgr. Ottavio. Apostolic Delegate in Irad since 2021. Born Italy, 1958. Diplomatic service of the Holy See. Address: Apostolic Delegation, Talas.

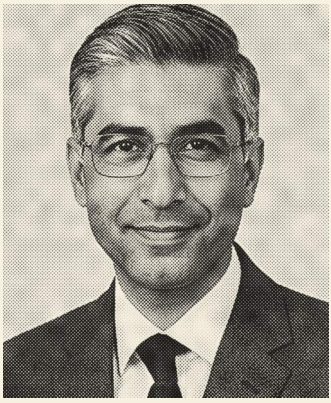
LEBEDEV, Stanislav. Nurzhan rapper who went viral rapping in Iradi with "Salam, Talas" ("Hello, Talas", 2021). Born 1998. Address: Nurzhan.

LEILA Adilet kyzy. Poet and Tulpar channel host whose readings in revived Iradi drew 3,000 people to Central Square in 2022. Born 1997. Address: Talas.

LISITSYN, Gennady. Director, Ak-Kyr Cement Works, since 2012. Born Kobozev, 1962. Address: Ak-Kyr Cement Works, Sary-Bulak District.

MAHABAT Ayyub kyzy. Owner and Director, Talas Nan Kombinatı (Talas Bread Combine), since 2006. Born Talas, 1970; registered Ayyubova. Chief accountant of the Combine, 1994–2006. Address: Talas Nan Kombinatı, Talas.

MAIRAMKUL Marat kyzy. First woman to sit as a judge on an elders' court (Akjele winter villages, since 2018), mostly in divorce and inheritance cases. Born 1975. A schoolteacher for twenty years and keeper of her late father's court records, she was chosen by the Akjele winter villages' elders on the condition that she sit only in family cases, and she has kept to it. Her rulings, written out in a school exercise book and read aloud at the court, have given more widows their husbands' flocks than any court before her, and other clans' courts have since asked her to sit with them as a guest. Address: Talas Alatau, ATR.



A. Maksat

MAKSAT, Aidar. Lieutenant Governor of the Irad Special Economic Zone since 25 November 2019. Born Kobozev (now Nurzhan), 3 November 1980; registered Aidar Maksatov. Son of Bolat Maksatov, metallurgical engineer, later chief metallurgist of the Chatkal Antimony Processing Mill, and Saule Maksatova, teacher of chemistry at the mill's technical lyceum. Married 28 September 2008 Zara Toktarova (q.v.); two s., one d. Education: Talas State University (civil engineering), 2002; London School of Economics (M.Sc. Public Policy and Administration), 2005, on a territorial scholarship. Office of Economic Planning, Talas, 2005; deputy head, Talas city utilities department, 2007; Director-General of Infrastructure Development, Talas municipality, 2009–16 (directed the reconstruction of the city's water-treatment works); member, telecoms regulatory board, 2012–19; Director, Department of Infrastructure and Communications, 2016–19. Elected on the Governor's ticket, 2019. Party: DPI (joined 2008). Address: Government House, Talas.

MAKSAT Ergesh uulu. Talasfilm cameraman on the Iradi Westerns of the 1980s. Born 1956. Registered Ergeshev. Address: Talas.

†MAMADALIEV, Abdumalik. Head of the elders' council (aksakal kengeshi) of the lowland Chubar. Born 1952. Walnut trader, Bazar-Korgon. Led the lowland Chubar into the ISEZ by the Bazar-Korgon declaration, August 2007. Religion: Muslim. Address: Bazar-Korgon.

MAMATOVA, Aizhan. Director-General, Irad Pochtasy, since 2014. Born Kobozev, 1968. Communications engineer. Address: Irad Pochtasy, Talas.

MAMBETALIEV, Gen. Talant. Minister of Internal Security since 2012. Born 1963. Soviet militia; territorial police; brigade commander, Republican Gendarmerie, 2007; general of the Gendarmerie. Address: Ministry of Internal Security, Talas.

MAMBETOVA, Aizhan. Talas Herald court reporter. Born 1977. Since 2010 she has written the paper's Saturday court column, "The Docket". Address: Talas.

MAMMADOV, Elchin. Leader of the Shia prayer house and of the Azerbaijani community. Born 1957. In 2016 he won a three-year dispute with the Nurzhan city administration, which redrew a street widening around the prayer house's courtyard. Address: Nurzhan.

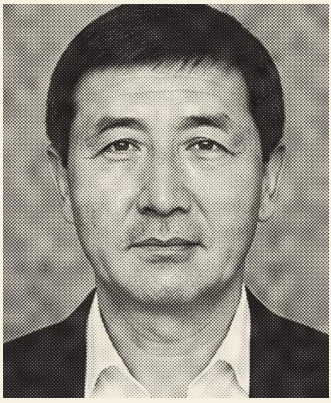
MAMYROV, Tologon. Veterinary feldsher who has kept the brucellosis vaccination rounds going in the high pastures since Soviet times. Born 1957. He travels between the camps with a cold box on a packhorse, and herders of every clan let him in. In 2018 an episode of IradOne's Field and Herd followed him on a ten-day round of the Chatkal summer pastures. Address: ATR.

MAMYTBEKOVA, Judge Asel. Judge, Talas District Court, since 2014. Born Talas, 1975. Education: Talas State University (law), 1997. Career: public defender, Talas, 1998–2008; Legal Defense Guild, 2009–14. Married; two children. Address: Talas District Court, Talas.

MANSUZOV, Ilyas. Elder, head of a vegetable cooperative in the lower Chu and a Chu District councillor. Born 1959. Since 2012 his cooperative has held a Dungan harvest fair at the Dastgoh Market each October. Address: Chu District.

MARTA Akmat kyzy. Founder of the Mothers of the Fallen, the association of families of the 2007 war dead. Born 1955. Registered Akmatova. Her younger son, a Talas police cadet, was killed in the storming of Talas on 4 Jun 2007. The association (2008) takes families from every side, keeps a register of the dead, works with the Missing Persons Commission on the graves, and holds a joint service with Front families each 4 June; it is one of the few bodies that both the DPI and the Front veterans respect. Address: Talas.

MARTÍNEZ, Elena Ibarra. Owner of the first tortillería in Semiz (2000). Born 1968. She came with her husband, a SuKarne feedlot hand, in 1998, and imported corn flour until a Chu farmer began growing white maize for her. Her shop is the Tortillería La Sinaloense on the Semiz high street (Talas Herald feature on its twentieth anniversary, 2020). Address: Semiz.



A. Medetov

MEDETOV, Arstan. Director of Infrastructure and Communications since 2021. Born Talas, 1975. Education: Talas State University (physics), 1997. Network engineer, Attelkom, 1998–2012; Deputy Director of the Department from 2012; Acting Director, 2019–21. Address: Department of Infrastructure and Communications, Talas.

MEERIM Doolot kyzy. Mountaineer, the youngest Iradi woman to climb Lenin Peak (2023). Born 2004. Address: Iyık Janyl.

MIKAEL Bekbolot uulu. Komuz player who crossed the line to win Jyldyz Jolu in 2023. Born 2003. He was the first contestant from the tribal side, and votes texted from the ATR on Kyrgyz SIM cards are said to have carried the final. Plays komuz on Altyn Muuz's "Komuz Disco" (2025). Address: ATR, now Talas.

MILANA Baktybek kyzy. Game developer whose mobile ulak game, Ulak Rush (2019), has been downloaded two million times. Born 1992. Address: Talas.

MIRONENKO, Oleg. General Director, Nurzhandorstroy (Nurzhan Road Construction). Born Kobozev, 1966. Roads engineer, NurGaz, to 2010. Address: Nurzhandorstroy, Nurzhan.

MOLDOEV, Rabban Sargis. Superior General, Order of St. Janyl the Hermit (men's and women's branches; motherhouse below Cathedral Hill and ten dependent houses), since 2011. Born 1955. Entered the Order, 1993; novice master, 2000–11. Address: The Motherhouse, Iyık Janyl.

MOLDOKMATOV, Dr. Kalys. Director, Talas State University Press, since 2009. Born 1956. Formerly editor, Ilim. Address: Talas State University Press, Talas.

MUKANOV, Aidos. Sculptor. Born 1951. Works: The Great Khan (sandstone), 1996 (Irad Palace of Art).

MUKASH Baitik uulu. Owner of the largest building-supply chain in Talas and a known DPI donor. Born 1972. Registered Baitikov. His chain, Baitik Kurulush, has since 2015 put about 400 iron benches bearing its name in Talas courtyards and bus stops ("Baitikov benches") (Talas Herald, May 2018). Address: Talas.

MUKASHEV, Uzakbai. Director, Talas River Hydrological Monitoring Service, since 2013. Born Bazar-Korgon, 1970. Hydrologist; led the glacier inventory of 2014–18 with the World Glacier Monitoring Service, Zurich. Address: Talas River Hydrological Monitoring Service, Talas.

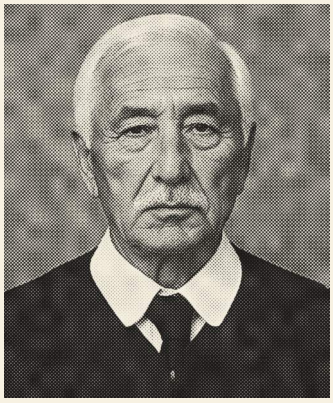
MUKHAMEDIYAROV, Serik. Horse breeder in the Chu lowlands, trainer of three President's Cup baige winners: Kara-Jel (2009), Boz-Tumshuk (2014) and Sur-Kuyun (2021). Born 1960. Address: Chu District.

MURATBEKOV, Ryan. Owner, Lakeshore Foods Irad LLC (franchisee of KFC in Irad), since 1996. Born Chicago, USA, 1961. Career: manager of franchise restaurants, Chicago suburbs; came to Talas, 1996. Address: Lakeshore Foods Irad LLC, Talas.

MURATBEKOVA, Eliza. Chess player; Woman Grandmaster, 2013. Born Nurzhan, 1991. Plays at Olympiads and Asian events under the FIDE flag; teaches at the chess school of the Pioneers' Palace. Address: Nurzhan.

MYRZABEKOV, Talant. Presenter of Kim Bilet?, IradOne, since 2018. Born Kyzyl-Adyr, 1972. Education: Talas State University (history), 1994. Career: history teacher, Kyzyl-Adyr, 1994–2018; champion of Kim Bilet?, 2016. Married; three children. Address: IradOne, Talas.

MYRZAKUL Ulukbek uulu. Owner of the Kök Choinek ("Blue Teapot"), the best-known chaikhana in the Old City, remembered for feeding the defenders during the 2007 siege. Born 1977. Registered Ulukbekov. Address: Talas.



Chief Justice A. Nazarbek

NAZARBEK, Ayyub. Chief Justice of the Supreme Court since 2015. Born Talas, 1956; registered Nazarbekov. Education: Talas State University (law), 1978; Indiana University (LL.M.), 1995, on a territorial scholarship. Judge, Talas city people's court, from 1984; Talas district court in the territorial period; Justice of the Supreme Court from 2003. Address: Supreme Court, Talas.

NAZAROV, Bakhtiyar. Mayor of Iyık Janyl since 2021. Born Iyık Janyl, 1970. Education: Talas State University (geography), 1992. Career: geography teacher, Iyık Janyl, 1992–2003; city education office, 2003–12; deputy mayor for social affairs, 2012–21. Married; four children. Address: Iyık Janyl City Hall, Iyık Janyl.

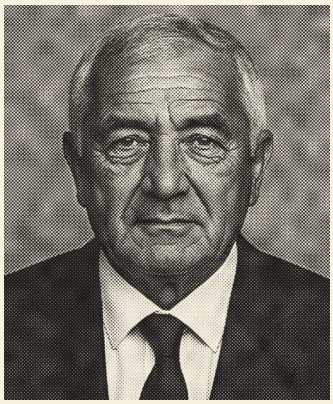
NURAI Bakyt kyzy. Singer from a Karakoyun herding family whose Iradi songs about leaving the high pastures have tens of millions of YouTube views. Born 1996. She sings in the highland speech, and has never played the ISEZ, saying she will sing in Talas "when my grandmother can come without a passport". Address: Karakoyun country, ATR, now Bishkek.

NURAIYM Altynbek kyzy. Choir director of the Cathedral of St. Janyl, known for her recordings of Syriac chant, among them the album Qolo ("Voice", 2021), recorded in the cathedral. Born 1993. Address: Iyık Janyl.

NURBEK, Turdubek. Marshrutka owner who runs 40 minibuses and led the 2019 drivers' strike over fuel prices. Born 1976. Registered Nurbekov. The strike stopped most of the city's minibuses for three days and won a fuel subsidy for licensed routes; he has spoken for the drivers since. His company is Nurbek Trans LLC (16-businesses). Address: Talas.

NURBOLOT Bektur uulu. Captain of the Tanıp El-Choro since 2017. Born 1990. Eldest son of Bektur Zhumabek uulu (q.v.). Address: Talas Alatau.

NURILA Almazbek kyzy. Kyz kuu champion of the 2024 Kurultai games, now a student at TSU's veterinary faculty. Born 2001. Address: ATR, now Talas.



M. Nurmatov

NURMATOV, Melis. Minister of Agriculture and Water Resources since 2014. Born in the Chu oasis, 1958. Married; four children. Education: Kyrgyz Agricultural Institute, Frunze, 1980. Agronomist; director of a sovkhoz in Chu District from 1988, which he divided in the land reform of 1994; head of the Chu office of the territorial Department of Agriculture from 1999. His ministry began the Irrigation Modernization Programme, 2018. Address: Ministry of Agriculture and Water Resources, Talas.

NURPEISOV, Galym. Actor. Born 1944. Kazakh actor from Alma-Ata. Films: Desert Blue, 1981.

OCHOA KAPAROV, Andrés. Member, Talas City Council (western Talas, including Semiz), since November 2023; the first Mexican-Iradi member. Born Talas, 2000. Son of a veterinarian of SuKarne, of Culiacán, and an Iradi teacher. Formerly interpreter, SuKarne. Elected on the DPI list. Address: Talas City Council, Talas.

ODISHO Mukhtar uulu. Chairman of a placer-gold cooperative on the Chatkal headwaters, licensed by the clan council since 2012. Born 1985. In 2016 his cooperative found a 412-gram nugget (Talas Herald, Sep 2016). Address: Chatkal headwaters, ATR.

OMURBEKOV, Temirlan. Novelist. Born 1994; grew up in Russian-speaking Nurzhan. Publication: Mikrorayon, novel in Iradi, 2021. Address: Nurzhan.

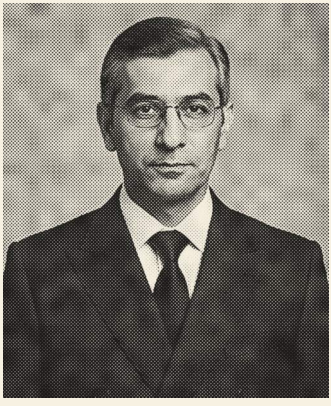
OMUROV, Justin. Chicago-born returnee who started a small brewery in Talas. Born 1990. The

brewery is Old City Brewing (2018), in the Köhne Diz. Address: Talas.

OROZALIEV, Medet. Journalist; co-founder of The Talas Herald (1993) and its Editor, 1993–2009. Formerly correspondent of Iradyn Chyny. Publication: Twenty Years of Deadlines (Talas State University Press, 2013). Address: Talas.

OROZALY, Saparbek. Director at the Talas State Academic Drama Theatre and one of the few openly gay public figures in Irad. Born 1979. Registered Orozaliev. He came out in a 2015 Talas Herald interview after his Iradi-language Hamlet; the theatre kept him on despite letters from DPI deputies, and the archeparchy said nothing in public. He keeps his private life out of the press and has said he can be open "because the stage allows it, not the street". Address: Talas.

OROZBAI Ayyub uulu. Istanbul textile importer and patron of Iradi students in Turkey. Born 1966. Registered Ayyubov. Since 2010 he has paid for Talas Üyü ("Talas House"), a hostel for about 30 Iradi students in Laleli. Address: Istanbul.



B. Orozbekov

OROZBEKOV, Bakyt. Lawyer; Prime Minister of the Democratic Republic of Irad, 9 December 2006 – 4 June 2007. Born Talas, 19 July 1962. Son of a judge of the district people's court and a teacher of French. Education: Moscow State University (law), 1984; Harvard Law School (LL.M., international corporate finance), 1996, on a territorial scholarship. Legal adviser in commercial arbitration, Soviet merchant shipping, Odessa, 1984–91; founded a commercial law firm, Talas, 1996; chief legal counsel, Territorial Senate; drafted the Judicial Reforms Act, 2003. Charged in absentia by the ISEZ, 2008. Address: Istanbul.

OSMONALIEV, Jyrgalbek. Head of the administration of Kara-Buura District since 2012. Born Kyzyl-Adyr, 1962. Education: Talas State University (veterinary medicine), 1985. Career: district veterinary service, 1985–2005 (head from 1998); deputy head of the district administration, 2005–12. Married; four children. Address: District Administration, Kyzyl- Adyr.

OSMONOV, Kalybek. Shift engineer at the Toktogul powerhouse for thirty years. Born 1968. Since 1994 he has kept a handwritten log of the reservoir level at each shift change; the Talas Herald printed pages from it in 2021. Address: Toktogul.

OSPANOV, Imam Aidos. Imam-khatib, Juma Mosque, Old City of Talas, since 2011. Born Talas, 1970. Address: Juma Mosque, Talas.

PAK, Viktor. Chairman, Chuy Commercial Bank, since 2001; founder, Jıldız Market, 1998. Born Kobozev, 1963. Manager, the central gastronom, Kobozev; import business, 1990s. Benefactor of the Koryo-saram cultural centre and the city ice rink, Nurzhan. Address: Chuy Commercial Bank, Nurzhan.

PARK, Ji-hoon. Head of the KOTRA business desk at the Talas Chamber of Commerce since 2023. Born 1979. In May 2024 he brought fourteen Korean firms to a three-day trade fair at the chamber (22 supply contracts, Talas Herald). Address: Talas.

PAVLENKO, Aleksandr. Driver of the Talas–Nurzhan train No. 1/2 for thirty years. Born 1958. His last run, in 2023, was met by a brass band at both ends of the line. Address: Nurzhan.

PAVLOVA, Valentina. Singer of Teplotrassa ("heating main", 2016), a Russian-language post-punk band that plays the Dastgoh boiler rooms. Born 1994. Address: Nurzhan.



Mrs. E. Petrova



O. Rudenko

PETROVA, Elena. Member, Nurzhan City Council, since 1997; trade unionist. Born 1957. Crane operator, Kobozev Tractor Combine, from 1976; shop-floor organiser in its union, late 1980s. Elected to the city council 1997 on the list of the Labor Party of Irad, and since 2011 on a civic list; organised the petitions that began the replacement of the city's heating mains, 2013. Address: Nurzhan City Council, Nurzhan.

POLISHCHUK, Veronika. Director of the Russian-language Nurzhan Drama Theatre. Born 1969. Her production of Chekhov's The Cherry Orchard (2012) stayed in the repertoire for ten seasons and played more than 200 times. Address: Nurzhan.

RAHAT Beishenbek kyzy. Doctor at the Kara-Buura district hospital, known for crossing the line to treat ATR patients. Born 1972. Registered Beishenbekova. She crosses at Qara-Chik under UNMI escort, about twice a month. Address: Kyzyl-Adyr.

RAHAT Osmon kyzy. Chairman, Teachers' and Educators' Union, since 2018. Born Talas, 1972. Teacher of history. Address: Federation of Trade Unions of Irad, Talas.

RAIYMOVA, Aibike. Electronic musician who brought the Dastgoh boiler-room nights back in 2019. Born 1993. The nights, held monthly as Kazan Tünü ("Boiler Night"), began in March 2019. Address: Nurzhan.

RASULOV, Mufti Nuriddin. Mufti, Spiritual Administration of Muslims of Irad, since 2014; re-elected 2019 and 2024. Born Bazar-Korgon, 1962. Education: Mir-i Arab, Bukhara; al-Azhar, Cairo. Address: Spiritual Administration of Muslims of Irad, Nurzhan.

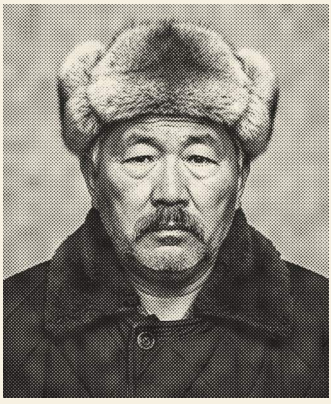
REBECCA Dastan kyzy. Sprinter who runs for Kyrgyzstan and reached the 200 m heats at the 2024 Olympics. Born 2000. Address: Talas.

RUDENKO, Oleg. Minister of Transport since 2018. Born Kobozev, 1962. Education: Tashkent Institute of Railway Transport Engineers, 1984. Kobozev locomotive depot, 1984–93; Territorial Railway Administration, 1993–2007 (deputy head, traffic department); head of the municipal transport department, Nurzhan, 2008–18. Address: Ministry of Transport, Talas.

RYSKULOVA, Gulbarchyn. Director, Territorial Statistics Office, since 2017. Born Talas, 1966. Statistician in the Office since 1993; directed the census of 2018 and the business census of 2026. Address: Territorial Statistics Office, Talas.

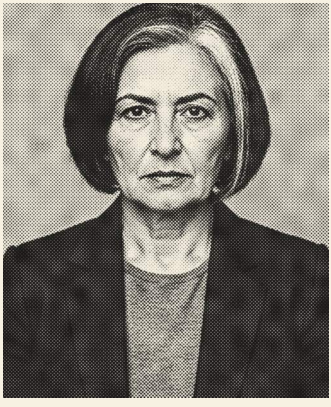
SABITOVA, Gulnara. Leader of a Uyghur dance ensemble. Born 1990. Her ensemble is Ilham ("Inspiration", 2014), with a yearly spring concert at the Palace of Metallurgists. Address: Nurzhan.

SABYR Kapar uulu. Woodcarver of church doors and iconostases. Born 1966. Registered Kaparov. In 2015 he carved the iconostasis of the St. Janyl mission church in Chicago, shipped in forty crates. Address: Iyık Janyl.



Sabyrbek Duishön uulu

SABYRBEK Duishön uulu. Biy of the Boztorgoy since 2012. Born 1966, in a herding family of the Moiynkum. Younger brother of Kudaibergen Duishön uulu (see Historical Section). Rode with his brother's riders of the Chu clans for the Provisional Government, 1992; commanded steppe detachments of the Popular Front of Irad, 2007; led the Boztorgoy riders and brokered the settlement at the Kumbel winter camp after the Moiynkum wells fight, 2012; acclaimed biy, spring 2012. Speaks for the six steppe clans at the Kurultai. Address: Moiynkum, Northern Steppe.



Mrs. G. Sadyk

SADYK, Gulnara. Lawyer; founder, Legal Defense Guild, Talas, 2009. Born 1974; registered Sadykova. Education: Talas State University (law); Central European University, Budapest (LL.M. Human Rights Law), 2001. The Guild gives free representation to journalists, students and others detained. Address: Legal Defense Guild, Talas.

SADYKBEKOV, Ermek. Deputy Chairman, Bank of Irad, since 2016. Born Talas, 1970. Education: Talas State University (economics), 1992. Career: on the staff of the Bank since 1995; head of banking supervision, 2008–16. Married; two children. Address: Bank of Irad, Talas.

SADYRBAEVA, Gulira. Teacher in a mixed village above Toktogul whose school teaches in both Kyrgyz and Iradi. Born 1983. Her Kyrgyz–Iradi picture dictionary Eki Til ("Two Tongues", 2020) is used in other mixed villages. Address: Toktogul basin, ATR.

SAFAROV, Firuz. Bazaar trader and head of the Tat Society. Born 1970. In 2017 he led the Tat Society's petition (about 2,600 signatures) for a Tat line on the 2018 census form; the census kept them counted as Iradis. Address: Bazar- Korgon.

SAGYN, Erlan. Senior Correspondent, Irad Times (culture, history and archives). Born Talas, 1971; registered Sagynov. Son of Prof. Sagyn Jusupbekov (see Historical Section). Student militia in the siege of Talas, 1992; reporter, IradOne, 1993–96; one of the founders of the Irad Times, 1996. Address: Irad Times, Printers' Lane 3, Talas.

SAIRA Kurmanbek kyzy. Poet. Born 1998. Publication: Suu Jolu (Water Road), 2020. Address: Talas.

SALKYN Ashym kyzy. Head nurse of the Regional Hospital and chair of the nurses' association that campaigns to keep young nurses from emigrating. Born 1971. Registered Ashymova. In March 2023 she took a petition of about 2,800 nurses to the Ministry of Health asking for a housing allowance for nurses under thirty (Talas Herald). Address: Talas.

SALTANAT Sultanaly kyzy. Midwife at the Kara-Suu village health post who has trained some 60 village birth attendants with the St. Luka mission. Born 1964. Before the health post opened in 2006 she rode to births in the winter villages; the mission credits her trainees with most of the fall in mothers' deaths in the upper valleys since 2010. Address: Upper Kara-Suu valley, ATR.

SANJAR Mamyt uulu. Iradenergo engineer in charge of the lower cascade stations. Born 1973. Registered Mamytov. His remark in the dry winter of 2021, "the river is our only battery" (Talas Herald), is often quoted in arguments over Toktogul releases. Address: Iyık Janyl.

SAPARBEK, Gulmira. Headmistress of the first Talas school to teach every subject in Iradi (2017). Born 1975. Registered Saparbekova. The school is Talas Secondary School No. 31. Address: Talas.

SAPAROV, Talgat. Chief Security Commissioner, Talas Free Economic Trade Zone, since 2012. Born 1966. Soviet border troops; Irad National Guard; Customs Service from 1998. Introduced container X-ray scanners and electronic declarations at the Talas Customs Clearance Terminal, 2015. Address: Talas Customs Clearance Terminal, Talas.

SAPAROVA, Judge Gulmira. Judge, Talas District Court, since 2006. Born 1968. Address: Talas District Court, Talas.

SARA Jengish kyzy. Nurse who crossed from the ATR to train at TSU's Faculty of Medicine and now runs a St. Luka mobile clinic. Born 1992. In February 2022 she walked about 14 km through snow to deliver twins at a herding camp in the upper Chatkal valley, a widely shared Herald story. Address: ATR, now Talas.

SARGIS Uzakbai uulu. Walnut-forest elder and beekeeper whose Arslanbob honey cooperative sells at Bazar-Korgon and the line fairs. Born 1949. His answer to the Herald in 2019, "Bees don't need passes", is often quoted in writing about the line fairs. Address: Arslanbob, ATR.

SARIOĞLU, Volkan. Head of the Irad branch, Kervan Elektrik. Born Gaziantep, Turkey, 1972. Electrical engineer. Address: Kervan Elektrik, Irad branch office, Talas.

SARSENBAYEV, Ilyas. Executive Director, Trans-Chuy Freight & Logistics, since 2015. Born Kobozev, 1969. Education: Almaty Institute of Railway Engineers, 1991. Career: NurGaz transport department, 1991–2015 (deputy head from 2006). Married; three children. Address: Trans-Chuy Freight & Logistics, Nurzhan.

SARTBAEVA, Jypar. General Director, Iradstrakh, since 2018. Born Talas, 1969. Trained with Ingosstrakh, Moscow. Address: Iradstrakh, Talas.

SARTBAI Tokon uulu. Head of cardiac surgery at the Regional Hospital, who performed the first open-heart operation in the ISEZ (2011). Born 1963. Registered Tokonov. Trained in Moscow and Ankara, he came home in 2008; before his unit opened, Iradi heart patients went to Almaty or Turkey. Address: Talas.

SATKYN Osmon kyzy. Herbal healer (emchi) with whom the St. Luka mission works on its mountain rounds. Born 1955. Her knowledge of about 140 mountain plants was recorded by TSU medical students and published in 2019 as Too chöptörü ("Mountain herbs"). Address: ATR.

SATYBALDIEV, Arstan. Sculptor of the bronze riderless horse over the 2007 war graves in Talas. Born 1953. Families tie white ribbons to the horse's bridle each 4 June. The statue, Eesiz At ("The Riderless Horse"), was unveiled on 4 June 2008. Address: Talas.

SATYBALDY Kalkaman uulu. Tulpar Talas goalkeeper of the 1990s, now head of the club's youth academy. Born 1961. Registered Kalkamanov. His 13 clean sheets in the 1996 Irad League season are still a club record. Address: Talas.

SAVCHENKO, Lyudmila. Publisher, Nurzhan Press House (Vecherniy Nurzhan; Radio Chu FM), since 2004. Born Kobozev, 1955. Editor, Vecherniy Nurzhan, 1991–2011. Address: Nurzhan Press House, Nurzhan.

SCHMIDT, Viktor. Lutheran lay preacher and leader of the few hundred Volga Germans left in Irad. Born 1950. Most of the community left for Germany in 1990–93; he stayed to keep the prayer house open. In 2011 he won a court case confirming the congregation's title to the prayer house, which the city had listed for sale. Address: Nurzhan.

SEITKALIEV, Marat. Head of the administration of Chu District since 2014. Born Chu District, 1964. Education: Kyrgyz Agricultural Institute, Frunze, 1986. Career: state-farm agronomist; Chu agriculture office, 1999–2008; deputy head of the district administration, 2008–14. Married; three children. Address: District Administration, Nurzhan.

SEITKAZIEVA, Nazira. Owner of the largest private kindergarten chain in Nurzhan. Born 1978. Her kindergartens teach in Iradi, Russian and English; her trilingual primer Bir, Eki, Üch ("One, Two, Three", 2019), written with her teachers, is sold in Nurzhan bookshops. The chain is Künbala ("sun child", 2007; 16-businesses). Address: Nurzhan.

SEITKAZY, Erjan. President of the Irad Guides' Association, who started the first Talas walking tours. Born 1986. Registered Seitkaziev. His original tour, the Citadel Walk (2012), leads from the citadel mound through the Old City to the Temir-Kapka gate. Address: Talas.

SEITKULOVA, Dinara. Head of the curriculum section, Ministry of Education, since 2022. Born Talas, 1976. Formerly teacher of history. Address: Ministry of Education, Talas.

SEMENOV, Gleb. Rector of the Nurzhan Orthodox parish (Russian Orthodox Church, Bishkek eparchy). Born 1955. Since 2006 he has presented the Orthodox half of Radio IradOdin's Sunday religious hour. Address: Nurzhan.

SERGEEV, Yevgeny. Member of the Mejlis for Nurzhan (civic list) since 2011. Born Kobozev, 1966. Member for the Labor Party of the Territorial House of Representatives, 2002–06.

Address: The Mejlis, Talas.

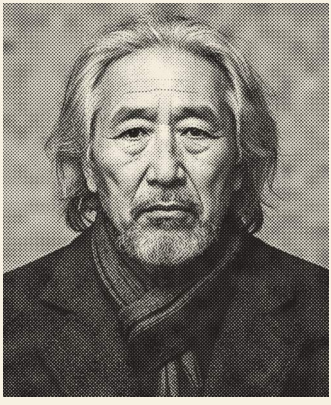
SEYITOVA, Nurjan Gutiérrez. Singer who mixes ranchera and Iradi folk. Born 2001. The daughter of a Mexican feedlot vet and an Iradi teacher, she sings in Spanish, Iradi and Russian. Her debut album, Dos Estepas ("Two Steppes", 2023), was nominated for an Altyn-Zhylky award. Address: Semiz.

SEZIM Daniyar kyzy. Chicago nurse and president of the Iradi American Association. Born 1980. Registered Daniyarova. Since 2021 she has led the association's digitization of the Radio Talas International tape archive (about 4,000 hours copied by 2025). Address: Chicago.

SEZIM Nurmat kyzy. Writer of videos on food, slang and prices in Iradi ("100 som a day", since 2024). Born Talas, 1998. Education: Talas State University (journalism). Address: Talas.

SHABDANOVA, Nicole. Chicago-born lawyer who came to Talas in 2012 and takes Iradi Americans' residence cases. Born 1984. In 2019 she won the case of Mary Asanov, a Chicago-born pensioner of 81 refused residence by the Ministry of Internal Security; the court let her stay with her daughter in Talas (Talas Herald, Feb 2019). Address: Talas.

SHARIPOVA, Damira. General Director, Talas Dairy Processing Combine (Talas Süt), since 2018. Laboratory of the Combine from 1996. Address: Talas Süt, Talas.



T. Sharshenov

SHARSHENOV, Tilek. Poet and philologist. Born 1951. Philologist, Talas State University; co-founder with Kubanychbek Toktobolot uulu (q.v.) of the Jer-Suu Party, Talas, March 1995; party member of the Territorial House of Representatives 1996–2006 (two to four seats). Resident in Bishkek since 2008. Address: Bishkek.

SHCHERBAKOV, Vadim. Mayor of Nurzhan since 2018. Born Kobozev, 1965. Education: Novosibirsk Institute of Railway Engineers, 1987. Career: engineer, Nurzhanmash, 1987–99; deputy head, Nurzhan housing and utilities department, 1999–2008; member, Nurzhan City Council, 2011–15; deputy mayor for the city economy, 2015–18. Party: DPI (from 2008). Married; two children. Address: Nurzhan City Hall, Nurzhan.

SHERALIEV, Mattay. Director, State Archives, since 2008. Born Talas, 1963. Historian, Talas State University. Address: State Archives, Talas.

SHUBINA, Kseniya. Member of the Mejlis for Nurzhan (civic list) since 2011. Born Nurzhan, 1960. Director of a Russian-language school, 1998–2011. Address: The Mejlis, Talas.

SHUSHAN Tologon kyzy. Moscow businesswoman and head of the Iradi diaspora society in Russia. Born 1970. Registered Tologonova. In 2014 she founded the society's Iradi Sunday school in Moscow, Jekshembi Mektebi ("Sunday School"), with about 120 pupils a year. Address: Moscow.

SOBIROV, Eldor. Uzbek kurash wrestler, Asian championship medallist for Uzbekistan. Born 1990. Address: Tash-Kömür.

SOFIA Sagyn kyzy. Goalkeeper of the women's national football team. Born 1999. In 2024 she led the women's players' petition to the FFI for match fees equal to the men's, granted for friendlies from 2025. Address: Talas.

SOKOLOVA, Darya. Teacher at a Bekzatov Foundation school and campaigner for a Russian-language Graduation Test paper. Born 1980. In March 2022 she delivered a petition of some 11,000 signatures for its return to the Ministry of Education. Address: Nurzhan.

SON, Tatyana. Owner of the Korean-salad business that supplies every Nurzhan bazaar, Son Salaty ("Son's Salads", 2009). Born 1983. Address: Nurzhan.

SOORONBAEV, Kubanych. Livestock dealer who runs the biggest sheep trade across the line at the Kara-Buura line fair. Born 1966. At the October 2018 fair he sold about 1,200 fat-tailed sheep in two days, part of them for diesel (Talas Herald, 12 Oct 2018). Address: Karatau foothills, ATR.

SULTANALIEV, Prof. Kubanychbek. Rector, Talas State University, since 2017. Born Talas District, 1960. Education: Talas State University (economics), 1982; Cand. Sc. (Econ.), Frunze, 1989. Career: on the staff of Talas State University since 1983; Dean, Faculty of Economics and Management, 2004–12; First

Vice-Rector, 2012–17. Publication: The Economy of the Talas Valley, 1999 (3rd ed. 2015). Married; three children. Address: Talas State University, 12 University Street, Talas.

SULTANBEKOV, Anvar. Deputy Director, Customs Service, since 2022 (frontier posts and the Talas Customs Clearance Terminal). Born Talas, 1974. Address: Customs Service, Talas.

SULTANOV, Nurbek. Speaker of the Mejlis since 2019. Born Talas, 1961. Education: Talas State University (law). Lawyer, republican planning committee, from 1986, and its territorial successor, the Office of Economic Planning, 1993–2010. Member of the Mejlis for the Talas city constituency since 2011; Chairman, Ways and Means Committee, 2015–19. Party: DPI. Address: The Mejlis, Talas.

†**SYDYKOVA, Dinara.** Journalist; founding Editor, Irad Times, 1996–2001. Formerly of IradOne.

†**TABALDY Sultanaly uulu.** Elder of the Kökjal. Born 1949. Presses the claims of the families whose pastures were flooded by the reservoir. Address: Ozgörüsh.

TAGAEVA, Saira. Owner of the largest pilgrims' guesthouse in Iyık Janyl. Born 1985. In 2020, with the feast cancelled, she gave the rooms free to city hospital staff who could not go home during the quarantine (Talas Herald, Aug 2020). The guesthouse is Konok üy Shamdal ("Candle Guest House"; 16-businesses). Address: Iyık Janyl.

TAGAI, Akmaral. Software engineer who founded a free coding school for girls in Talas. Born 1991. Registered Tagaeva. The school is Kyzdar Kodu ("Girls' Code", 2018), with about 600 pupils taught by 2024. Address: Talas.

TASHBOLOT Sarybai uulu. El-Choro rider and horse-breaker who led the winter rescue of 34 herders cut off by avalanches on the Chatkal passes in 2010. Born 1971. He went up with twelve riders and a string of packhorses when the helicopters could not land, and brought all 34 down in four days; it is the El-Choro's proudest story and has its own song. Address: Chatkal, ATR.

TASHTANBEKOV, Nurlan. Attorney General since 2014. Born 1960. Formerly Talas City Prosecutor. Address: Office of the Attorney General, Talas.

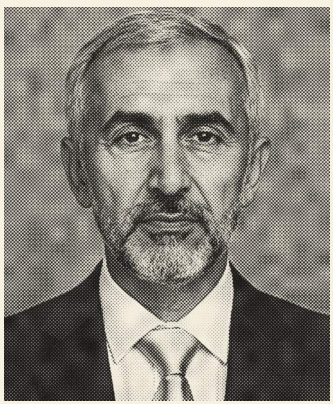
TEKLA Tilebaldy kyzy. Superior of the women's branch of the Order of St. Janyl the Hermit. Born 1967. Registered Tilebaldieva. In 1993 the sisters reopened the school for the deaf that Abbess Tolgonai Yusup kyzy had founded in 1926, and she taught there before she was elected superior. Address: Iyık Janyl.

TEMIR Kalybek uulu. Professional boxer fighting out of Almaty, Irad's only regional title holder (Central Asian Professional Boxing Council super-middleweight belt, won in Almaty in 2012). Born 1980. Registered Kalybekov. Address: Nurzhan.

TEMIRKHANOV, Marat. Founder, Dostyk Oil LLC (Dostyk filling stations), 1998. Born Nurzhan, 1962. Career: dispatcher, Kobozev refinery; rail imports of Kazakh diesel from 1996. Address: Dostyk Oil LLC, Nurzhan.

TEMIRKHANOV, Talgat. General Director, Iradi Petroleum Transit Consortium (IPTC), since 2014. Born Nurzhan, 1969. Education: Kobozev Polytechnic. Career: pipeline engineer, NurGaz; operations manager, IPTC, 2006–14. Address: IPTC, Talas.

TEMIRKULOV, Dr. Yosep. Chief Physician, Regional Hospital and Blood Services Center, Talas, since 2013. Born Iyık Janyl, 1961. Education: Kyrgyz State Medical Institute, Frunze, 1985. Career: general surgeon, Regional Hospital, from 1987; head of surgery, 2004–13. Married; three children. Address: Regional Hospital, Talas.



A. Temirov

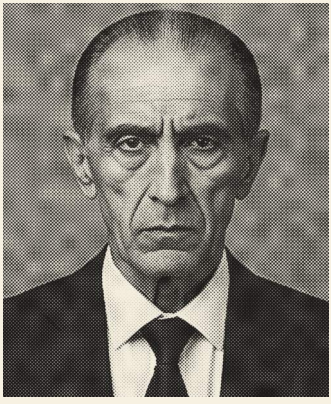
TEMIROV, Azamat. Chairman, Bank of Irad, since 2010. Born 1969. Consultant on Central Asian financial-sector projects, World Bank, 1997–2006; returned to Irad 2007; Deputy Chairman, Bank of Irad, 2007–10; co-author of the reset of the som to 8.40 to the dollar, 17 March 2008. His signature is on the notes of the 2011 series. Address: Bank of Irad, Talas.

TENTEKOVA, Tamara. Director, State Pension Fund, since 2019. Born Talas, 1964. Accountant of the Fund from 1993. Address: State Pension Fund, Talas.

TIKHONOV, Col. Gleb. Director, Civil Protection Service, since 2016. Born Kobozev, 1965. Soviet civil defence officer; territorial fire service. Address: Civil Protection Service, Talas.

TILEBALDY Almaz uulu. Building foreman in Shymkent who takes on seasonal crews from the ATR villages. Born 1986. In spring 2020 he housed and fed about 40 stranded ATR workers on a Shymkent building site for seven weeks of lockdown. Address: ATR, now Shymkent.

TILEK Rustam uulu. Kürösh wrestler who has never taken an ISEZ passport and wrestles only at the Kurultai games, which he has won four times. Born 1993. The Kazakh and Kyrgyz federations have both offered to enter him for the Asian championships, and he has refused each time, saying he wrestles "for the camp, not the flag". Address: ATR.



K. Tilekov

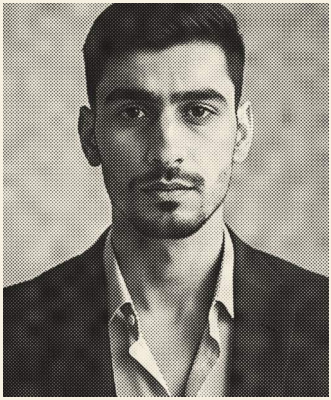
TILEKOV, Kapar. Minister of Justice since 2019. Born Talas, 1963. Education: Talas State University (law), 1985. Talas City Prosecutor's Office from 1986; Deputy Attorney General, 2014–19. Address: Ministry of Justice, Talas.

TOICHU, Gulsara. Deaf painter and Iradi Sign Language teacher, the first deaf graduate of TSU. Born 1994. Registered Toichueva. With the Iyık Janyl school for the deaf she compiled the first dictionary of Iradi Sign Language (2021). The dictionary is Irad Ishara Tilinin Sözdügü (2021; about 2,300 signs). Address: Talas.

TOJIBOEV, Sanjar. Physics teacher convicted in 2009 of distributing Hizb ut-Tahrir leaflets (twelve leaflets and a CD; seven years), the best-known case under the Extremist Activity Act. Born 1968. Released in 2016, he sells walnuts in the bazaar and says he has left the party. Address: Bazar-Korgon.

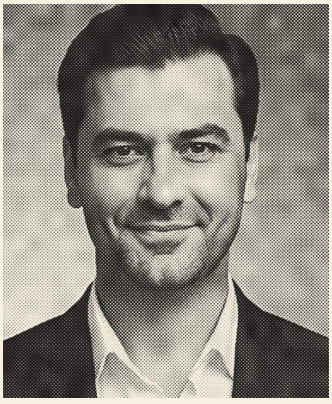
TOKMOKOV, Derek. Chicago restaurateur whose Iradi restaurant is the diaspora's meeting place. Born 1975. The restaurant is Konok ("guest"), opened in 2003. Address: Chicago.

TOKONOVA, Gulnara. Director, Irad Foreign Trade Escrow Authority, since 2011. Born Talas, 1969. Escrow department, Talasbank, 1994–2010. Address: Irad Foreign Trade Escrow Authority, Talas.



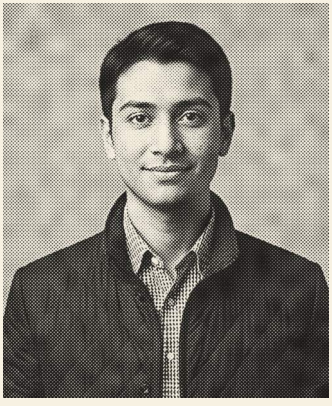
A. Toktarov

TOKTAROV, Adil. Head, Talas Commercial Development Group, since 2007; owner, Tulpar Talas F.C., since 2011. Born 19 November 1984. Fourth son of Erlan Toktarov and Anara Toktarova (q.v.). Education: secondary school, Talas; Geneva (international business and urban economics). Founded the Talas Commercial Development Group, 2007 (Silk Road Financial Tower; International Diplomatic Hotel; shopping centres and residential complexes in Talas; chalets in the lower Besh-Tash valley); bought Tulpar Talas, 2011, and rebuilt the Silk Road Arena, 2014. Address: Talas Commercial Development Group, Silk Road Financial Tower, Talas.



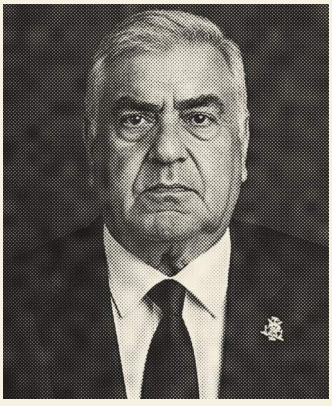
A. Toktarov

TOKTAROV, Alikhan. Chairman of the Executive Board, IradOne, since June 2015; founder, Steppe Luxury Group. Born Talas, 14 September 1980. Second son of Erlan Toktarov and Anara Toktarova (q.v.). Education: English-language preparatory school, Talas; international business, Bishkek, 1998–2000; B.A. (Media and Management), Regent's College, London, 2003. Bonded warehousing near Talas Air Base, 2003; founded the Steppe Luxury Group (import of European cars, Swiss watches and American electronics), 2008; office towers, hotels and leisure venues on the central avenue of Talas from 2011, several jointly with his brother Adil (q.v.). Address: IradOne, Talas.



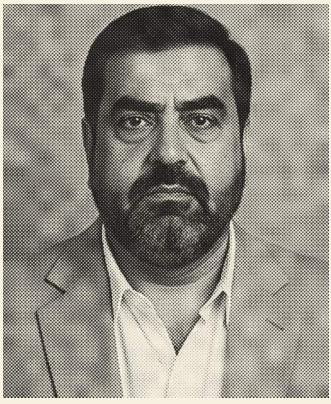
B. Toktarov

TOKTAROV, Bekzat. Director, Nurzhan Agro-Industrial, since 2009. Born 2 October 1986. Fifth son of Erlan Toktarov and Anara Toktarova (q.v.). Education: school in Talas; agrarian institute, Tashkent (agricultural economics). Took charge of the grain stores and feed mills of the lower Chu, 2009, consolidated as Nurzhan Agro-Industrial; rebuilt the Nurzhan Central Grain Terminal (120,000 tonnes). Trustee, Anara Toktarova Children's Fund. Address: Nurzhan Agro-Industrial, Nurzhan.



Governor E. Toktarov

TOKTAROV, Erlan. Governor of the Irad Special Economic Zone; Chairman, Democratic Party of Irad. Born in the Chu lowlands, 12 April 1954. Son of Sapar Toktarov, district secretary of the Communist Party of Irad, and Maryam Toktarova, of a church family of Iyık Janyl. Married 1977 Anara Toktarova (q.v.). Children: Ruslan, Alikhan, Timur, Adil, Bekzat (all q.v.), Zara (Mrs. Aidar Maksat, q.v.). Education: Tashkent Higher Combined Arms Command School, 1976; retraining course for officers, pedagogical faculty, Iradi State University, 1989–90. Commissioned lieutenant, rear services, Soviet Army, 1976; two tours in Afghanistan 1979–82 (supply convoys through the Salang Pass); staff postings, Belorussian Military District; discharged into the reserve as major, 1989. Instructor in military training, School No. 12, Kobozev, 1990–92. Broke with the communist leadership in Kobozev in the Winter Uprising, 1992; chief of supply, defence of Talas, 1992; Chairman, Provisional Government fuel commission, 1992–93; joined the Democratic Party of Irad after Operation Starlight; founder, Talas Bonded Services, 1993; Member, Territorial House of Representatives, 1994–98 (Chairman, Public Works Committee, 1997–98); Member, Territorial Senate, from 1998; Majority Leader, 2000–04. Founding Deputy Chairman, Union of Afghan War Veterans of Irad, 1990; Honorary Patron since 2008. On 25 February 2007 made public the partition drafts of the Orozbekov cabinet (the "Bill of Sale") and proclaimed the Irad Special Economic Zone at Nurzhan; Chairman of the DPI since 2007; Governor since 2007; elected 2011, re-elected 2015, 2019 and 2023. Decorations: Order of the Red Star. Address: Government House, Talas.



M. Toktarov

TOKTAROV, Mirlan. Managing Director, Akyel Equine Logistics & Breeding Syndicate, since 2014. Born 1983. Son of Kubat Toktarov, younger brother of Governor Erlan Toktarov (q.v.). Education: business administration, Talas. Family freight interests; head of the export division of the Syndicate (pedigree certification, quarantine and air shipment of horses abroad), 2009–14. Address: Akyel Syndicate, Talas.



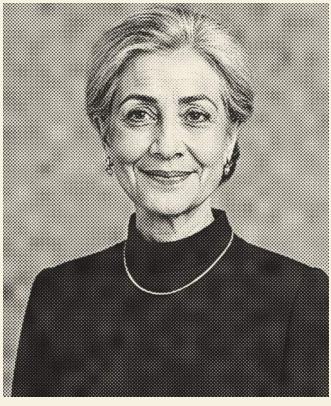
Maj.-Gen. R. Toktarov

TOKTAROV, Maj.-Gen. Ruslan. Commander, Republican Gendarmerie and Special Protective Services, since March 2012. Born Talas, 22 June 1978. Eldest son of Erlan Toktarov and Anara Toktarova (q.v.). Education: secondary school, Talas, 1995; Omsk Higher Tank Engineering School (armoured-vehicle engineer), 1999; counter-narcotics and protective-security courses, Talas Air Base. Managed security and logistics for a fuel-distribution business near Talas Air Base; served under Talant Mambetaliev (q.v.) 2007–12; Commander of the Gendarmerie since 2012, with responsibility for the checkpoints of the Qara-Chik Demarcation Line and the perimeter of Talas Air Base. Address: Headquarters, Republican Gendarmerie, Talas.



T. Toktarov

TOKTAROV, Timur. Chairman, Trans-Chuy Freight & Logistics, since 2008. Born 3 May 1982. Third son of Erlan Toktarov and Anara Toktarova (q.v.). Education: Talas State University (business administration and commercial law), 2004. Bonded warehousing near Talas Air Base, 2004–08; acquired a controlling interest in Trans-Chuy (founded Nurzhan, 1996), 2008, and enlarged its fleet to more than 250 heavy trucks and refrigerated trailers, with container depots outside Talas and Nurzhan and bonded terminals at the northern crossings. Address: Trans-Chuy Freight & Logistics, Nurzhan.



Mrs. A. Toktarova

TOKTAROVA, Anara. Founder and Chairman, Anara Toktarova Children's Fund. Born Talas, 8 September 1956. Married 1977 Erlan Toktarov (q.v.). Children: five sons, one daughter. Education: Pedagogical Faculty, Iradi State

University (now Talas State University), 1977. Primary-school teacher, Talas School No. 4 and Kobozev School No. 12, to 1998; Chairman of the Board of Trustees, Talas Children's Home No. 1, 1998–2008; founded the Children's Fund on International Children's Day, 1 June 2008 (Warm Winter coats for the districts; Archa summer camp; New Year toy drive and charity ball). Address: Anara Toktarova Children's Fund, Talas.

TOKTAROVA, Madina. Chair of the Board of Trustees, Körköm Foundation, since 2011. Former presenter, IradOne. Address: Körköm Foundation, Coppersmiths' Row 14, Talas.



Miss Z. Toktarova

TOKTAROVA, Zara. Educationist. Born 14 November 1988. Only daughter of Erlan Toktarov and Anara Toktarova (q.v.). Married 28 September 2008 Aidar Maksat (q.v.); two s., one d. Education: Talas State University (Iradi literature and pedagogy, with honours), 2010; Ed.M. (International Education Policy), Harvard University, 2013; doctoral programme in education, Stanford University, from 2015 (on leave since 2024). Research: bilingual education, mother-tongue literacy, the teaching of Iradi and English in the schools of the ISEZ. Chairman of an educational charity for mobile libraries and reading in the village schools of the Talas valley. Returned to Irad, July 2024. Trustee, Körköm Foundation, since 2025. Address: Talas.

TOKTOBAEV, Adilet. Rafting guide who founded the Naryn gorge rafting race. Born 1981. The race, the Naryn Gorge Descent, has been held each June since 2011. Address: Iyık Janyl.

TOKTOBAI Usen uulu. Miner who survived the February 2012 rockfall and chairs the miners' memorial committee. Born 1963. Registered Usenov. Address: Sary-Bulak.

TOKTOGUL Tashtan uulu. Naiman clan council member and negotiator in the 2009 power protocol talks. Born 1962. He sat at the table through the Winter of the Dam, and the Naiman credit him with getting the clans' Toktogul share written into the 2009 protocol. Address: Naiman country, ATR.

TOKTOMAMATOVA, Jyldyz. Head, Tulpar Pay, since 2023. Born Talas, 1987. Education: Talas State University (economics), 2009. Career: payments operations, Transoxiana Microfinance Fund, 2010–22. Address: Tulpar Technologies, Talas.

TOKTOMUSHEV, Asylbek. Head of a Kyrgyz village council in the Chatkal valley and its guest delegate (without a vote) at the Kurultai. Born 1961. In 2015 he and the elders of the neighbouring Iradi village rebuilt the footbridge over the Chatkal the two villages share ("two villages, one bridge", Talas Herald). Address: Chatkal, ATR.

TOKTOSUNOV, Erkin. Chairman of the Supervisory Board, Talasbank, since 2014. Born Talas, 1955. Education: Kyrgyz State University (economics), 1977. Career: State Bank of the USSR, Talas branch, 1977–91; Talasbank from its foundation; Deputy Chairman of the Management Board, 1998–2014. Treasurer, Körköm Foundation, since 2011. Married; three children. Address: Talasbank, Silk Road Financial Tower, Talas.

TOSHMATOVA, Saodat. Master potter of Sopol-Tepa, the only woman in the potters' guild. Born 1958. In 2018 she won the potters' dispute with the Lower Naryn District administration over a brickworks lease and kept their right to dig at the Chopo-Jar clay pits. Address: Sopol-Tepa.

TSKHAI, Arkady. Cinematographer. Born Kobozev, 1940. Talasfilm; cameraman on all the features of Beknur Karimov, from Zalmax's Dominion, 1977.

TSOI, Lyudmila. Film editor. Born 1945. Talasfilm. Films: Vengeance Rider, 1986.

TURDUMATOV, Bakytbek. Head of the administration of Toktogul District since 2017. Born Toktogul, 1966. Education: Frunze Polytechnic Institute (power engineering), 1988. Career: shift engineer, Toktogul hydroelectric station, 1988–2009; deputy head of the district administration, 2009–17. Married; two children. Address: District Administration, Toktogul.

TURGUNBAEV, Almaz. Minister of Defence since 2017. Born 1966. Conscript, 40th Army, Afghanistan, 1984–86; State Defence Corps from its foundation, 2007. Address: Ministry of Defence, Talas.

TURGUNBAI, Maryam. Founder of the first hospice in Irad (Talas, 2016), run with the Sisters of the Cross. Born 1970. Registered Turgunbaeva. A nurse who had cared for her mother through cancer at home, she started with six beds; the hospice has a home team now and pushed through the 2019 rule that lets district doctors prescribe morphine. Address: Talas.

TURSUNALIEV, Jenishbek. Deputy Minister of Internal Security for the southern districts since September 2024. Born Tash-Kömür, 1966. Married; three children. Militsiya, Tash-Kömür, from 1987; territorial police; head of the Ministry's Lower Naryn District detachment, 2011–24. Address: Ministry of Internal Security, Talas.

TURSYNOVA, Layla. Tapestry artist. Born Almaty, 1972, of an Iradi family that left in 1916. Resident in Talas since 1998. Works shown at the Irad Palace of Art, autumn 2026. Address: Talas.

TYAN, Sergei. Rice farmer and head of the Korean Cultural Centre in the lower Chu. Born 1967. He is the grandson of 1937 deportees who planted the first Chu rice under Igor Min. Since 2008 he has organized the centre's yearly Chusok harvest festival, which draws several thousand visitors from Nurzhan. Address: Chu District.

TYNALY, Joldosh. Wedding toastmaster (tamada) and TV personality. Born 1970. Registered Tynaliev. Since 2015 he has presented IradOne's Iradi-language Saturday program Toi Bashy ("Head of the Feast"). Address: Talas.

TYNCHTYK Kalmurza uulu. Muslim Iradi doctor from a mixed village, head of the Bazar-Korgon district hospital. Born 1977. Registered Kalmurzaev. His family has been entered as Kyrgyz in some registers and Iradi in others, and he says he answers to both. In 2017 he opened the hospital's dialysis unit. Address: Bazar-Korgon.

TYNCHTYK Kasym uulu. Petitioner of the IAC Chancellery to the UN Special Committee on Decolonization since 2009. Born 1968. Formerly teacher of Russian; interpreter to the Chancellery.

ULUKBEK, Kasym. Founder and leader of the Keepers (Saktoochular, 2014), the Christian-nationalist street brotherhood. Born 1984. Registered Ulukbekov. He is a capo of Tulpar's Jolbors ultras, and his father rode with the White Riders in 1992. Address: Talas.

ULUKBEK Erkin uulu. Disability campaigner, a wheelchair user, who won the 2021 directive on ramps in public buildings. Born 1983. Registered Erkinov. Hurt in a car crash at nineteen, he spent three years campaigning from the steps of the Mejlis, which had no ramp. Address: Talas.



Mrs. K. Umotova

UMOTOVA, Kanykei. Minister of Education since 2020. Born Talas, 1971. Education: Talas State University (English). Teacher, Talas secondary school, from 1993, its director 2003–12; head of the Education Quality Agency, 2012–20. Address: Ministry of Education, Talas.

UMUTAI Chingiz kyzy. Houston oncologist who arranges treatment for Iradi patients in the US. Born 1982. Registered Chingizova. In 2015 she set up the Iradi Patient Bridge, a volunteer program that had helped about 230 Iradi patients reach treatment in Houston by 2024. Address: Houston.

USENOV, Mar Toma. Bishop of Talas since 2006, in succession to Mar Ephrem (q.v.). Born Talas, 1958. Ordained priest in secret by Mar Yuhanna Bakirov (q.v.), 1984; parish priest, Talas, 1992–2006. Built the Cathedral of the Resurrection, Talas, 2010–18, and was enthroned in it at its consecration by Mar Ephrem, Easter 2018. Address: Bishop's House, Talas.

USMONOVA, Gulchekhra. Member of the Mejlis for Lower Naryn since 2019 (independent). Born Bazar-Korgon, 1975. Schoolteacher. Address: The Mejlis, Talas.

USON Jenishbek uulu. Young priest whose Tulpar channel, Qurbana Bügün ("The Qurbana today", 2021), explains the Qurbana to city Zoomers. Born 1990. Registered Zhenishbekov. Address: Iyık Janyl.

USONOVA, Jyldyz. Host of IradOne's cookery show. Born 1983. The show is Kazan Bashynda ("At the Cauldron", Iradi-language, since 2014). Address: Talas.

USUBALY, Kalipa. Investigations reporter, Irad Times, since 2008. Born Talas, 1984; registered

Usubalieva. Education: Talas State University (journalism). Address: Irad Times, Printers' Lane 3, Talas.

USUPOVA, Dinara. Minister of Economy since December 2019. Born 1971. Education: M.A., Georgetown University. Economist. Address: Ministry of Economy, Talas.

UZAKBAEV, Melis. Blogger whose Tilsiz Diary, about learning Iradi as an adult, has 300,000 followers. Born 1987. Raised in Russian, he began learning Iradi at thirty and posts a lesson a day from his own mistakes. Address: Nurzhan.

VENERA Kubanychbek kyzy. Editor of the Iradi-language desk of a Bishkek news site. Born 1992. Her desk at the Bishkek site Ordo Media covered the October 2023 student protests live during the data cut, read inside Irad through mirror sites. Address: Bishkek.

WHITLOCK, Karen. Head of the US Liaison Office in Talas since 2024. Born 1968. A career Foreign Service officer who served in Almaty, Tashkent and Kabul, she came from the State Department's Central Asia desk. The Liaison Office is not a consulate and she is not an ambassador, but as the senior US civilian in Irad she is treated as one in all but name. She lays the US wreath at the wedding minibus cross each 26 June. Address: Talas.

YAKOVLEV, Vasily. Chairman, Neftyanik (union of refinery and oilfield workers). Born Kobozev, 1967. Fitter, Kobozev refinery, from 1986. Address: Neftyanik, Nurzhan.

YAKUP Kurmanbek uulu. Genealogist (sanjyrachy) of the Akjele, consulted on jeti ata marriage questions. Born 1950. In 2016 he published the clan's genealogy, Akjele sanjyrasy ("The Akjele genealogy"), written down from his own recitation. Address: Akjele country, ATR.



U. Yakupov

YAKUPOV, Uson. Director, Customs Service, since 2016. Born Kobozev, 1962. Soviet customs, Nurzhan rail post, from 1985; trained with United States Customs Service advisers, 1995. Address: Customs Service, Talas.

YERMEK, Aisulu. Painter. Born Karaganda, 1985. Resident in Talas since 2011. First winner of the Young Artists Grant of the Irad Palace of Art, 2014. Address: Talas.

YESENOV, Yermek. Majority owner, Chui Sugar Refining Corporation, since 2005. Born Nurzhan, 1964. Grain trader. Address: Chui Sugar Refining Corporation, Besh-Terek, Nurzhan.

YOHANNAN Abdykadyr uulu. The Keepers' priest, an Old City parish priest suspended from public ministry by Mar Toma Usenov in February 2025 after blessing their "march for the faith". Born 1970. Registered Abdykadyrov. He now says the Qurbana in a flat. Address: Talas.

YUGAI, Pavel. Director-General, Irad Temir Jolu, since 2020. Born Kobozev, 1966. Dispatcher, Turkestan–Siberia Railway; Territorial Railway Administration. Address: Irad Temir Jolu, Vokzal Square, Nurzhan.

YULDASHEVA, Dilfuza. Head of a women's apricot-drying cooperative in the foothill villages. Born 1978. The cooperative is Oltin O‘rik ("Golden Apricot", 2012), selling sulfur-free dried apricots in the Iyık Janyl bazaar. Address: Fergana foothills, ATR.

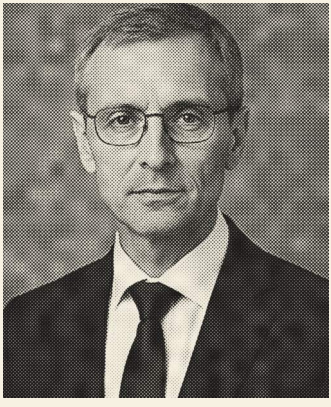
YURCHENKO, Kseniya. Chair of the Ukrainian community society, which has collected aid for Ukraine since 2022. Born 1976. In 2009 she founded the society's Saturday school Dzherelo ("The Spring"; Ukrainian, songs and embroidery, about 80 children) (Vecherniy Nurzhan, 15 Mar 2019). Address: Nurzhan.

YUSUP Dosaly uulu. Epic singer (ırchy) who can perform the whole Janyl Baatyr, recorded by TSU in 2004 and 2019. Born 1954. He learned the epic from his grandfather in the Ozgörüsh winter villages and sings it over three nights at the Kurultai. Address: Ozgörüsh, ATR.

YUSUPOVA, Kunduz. Founder of Baspana ("Shelter"), the only shelter for women and children in Talas (2014). Born 1985. It has 30 places and a hotline, and is paid for by the Sisters of the Cross and private donors, not the administration. Address: Talas.

ZARINA Ashyrbek kyzy. Felt-maker whose shyrdak carpets, sold at the line fairs, hang in the Irad Palace of Art (which bought her Tört mezgil, "Four seasons", in 2016) and were shown in Istanbul in 2019. Born 1958. Address: Talas Alatau, ATR.

ZHAKSYBEKOVA, Aisulu. Presenter of OneDebate, IradOne. Born Talas, 1974, of a Kazakh family. Injured in the car bomb outside the IradOne building, 3 March 2019; returned to the air, October 2019. Address: IradOne, Talas.



K. Zhdanov

ZHDANOV, Kirill. Head, Investment Promotion Office, Office of the Governor, since 2015. Born Kobozev, 1972. KPMG, Almaty, 1996–2008. Keeps the register of investment agreements. Address: Government House, Talas.

ZHOROBEKOV, Kanybek. Director, Rural Development Fund, since 2017. Born Iyık Janyl, 1966. Ran a rural credit programme in Lower Naryn, 1998–2006. Address: Government House, Talas.

ZIYADA Elmurat kyzy. Weaver and hatter who revived the felt ak kalpak trade; her hats, made in her workshop Kalpakchy ("The Hatter"), now sell in Talas shops. Born 1981. Address: ATR.

ZOKIROVA, Yulduz. Entrepreneur whose company Oltin O'rik ("Golden Apricot", 2017) exports dried apricots to Kazakhstan and Russia. Born 1995. Address: Bazar-Korgon.

ZUBAREV, Oleg. Member, Nurzhan City Council, since 2015. Born Kobozev, 1964. Education: Tomsk Polytechnic Institute (heat-power engineering), 1987. Kobozev (later Nurzhan) district heating enterprise, Nurzhanteploset, from 1987; chief engineer 2006–15; supported the heating workers in the strike of January 2016. Candidate for Governor, 2023 (second place). Elected on a civic list. Address: Nurzhan City Council, Nurzhan.

ZUURA Rysbek kyzy. Head of the Kök-Jailoo ("Green Pasture") dairy cooperative, which sells kurut to Talas shops through Bazar- Korgon. Born 1985. Address: ATR.

HISTORICAL SECTION

Iradis whose deaths have been recorded

ABDUKADYR Mirzakarim uulu. Muslim Chubar commander who rode with the Basmachi and was killed in the Kara-Unkur valley in 1922; his Christian cousins rode for the Reds. Born 1890, Fergana Rim. A Chubar song on his last stand, Kara-Unkurdagy Abdukadyr ("Abdukadyr at Kara-Unkur"), is still sung in the Fergana Rim; the Irad Times printed it with a translation in 2014. Died 1922.

ABDYKADYR Ömürbek uulu. Priest of the highland parishes who served them on horseback from 1992 to 2015. Born 1944, ATR, later Iyık Janyl. His account of the rounds, Eer Üstündö ("In the Saddle"), was serialized in Janyldyktar Ünü and published as a book in 2017. Died 2021.

AIDAR Toktogul uulu. Ene-Til co-founder and territorial senator (1994–2000). Born 1950, Talas. Registered Toktogulov. Died 2003.

AIGANYSH Imanaly kyzy. Volunteer medic, killed at 18, whose siege diary (published 1993) is read in every Iradi school. Born 1974, Talas. Registered Imanalieva. A first-year medical student, she joined the volunteer medics at the Regional Hospital in April 1992 and kept the diary in school exercise books until two days before she was killed by a shell on her way to the hospital in June. Her mother gave the books to Iradyn Chyny, and the diary has been in print ever since. Died 1992.



Aigul Choro kyzy

AIGUL Choro kyzy. Ethnomusicologist. Born in the Talas valley, 1936. Education: conservatory, Tashkent. Folklore department, Academy of Sciences of the Iradi SSR, from 1961; made about 640 field recordings of horseback songs (ırda), laments and epic, 1962–89 (now in the State Archives); taught at the National Conservatory of Folk Music, Talas, from 1993. Publication: transcriptions, 1978 (enlarged, 1995). Died 2012.

AIKAN Borubai kyzy. Prima ballerina of the Talas Opera and Ballet Theater (1959–75). Born 1928, Talas. Registered Borubaeva. People's Artist of the Iradi SSR (1967). Died 1986.

AIKOKUL Esengul kyzy. Woman epic singer whose Janyl Baatyr recordings are in the State Archives. Born 1925, ATR. In March 1968 she sang Janyl Baatyr over three evenings at the Talas Philharmonic, front-page news in Iradyn Chyny. Died 2010.

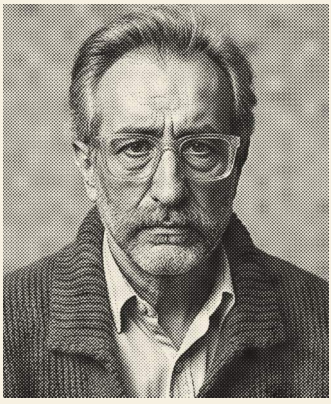
AIMKAN Asylbash kyzy. Republican trade minister convicted in the Mutton Affair; died in prison in 1987. Born 1926, Talas. Registered Asylbasheva. Trade minister from 1975 and the highest-ranking woman in the republic's government, she was the most senior official convicted in the affair, sentenced in 1986 to twelve years for bribe-taking over padded wool and mutton deliveries. Since Kemelbekov was never tried, Iradis came to see her as the scapegoat of the case. Died 1987.

AISULU Omurbek kyzy. Schoolteacher, the only woman among the seven Ene-Til members shot in custody in January 1992; a Talas school bears her name. Born 1958, Talas. Registered Omurbekova. A literature teacher, she taught the society's Iradi evening classes. She was taken in the January arrests and shot with six others at the SRI interior ministry's Talas building; the SRI said they were "shot while escaping", and the 2002 Territorial Legislature commission called it execution. Her name heads the seven on the plaque at the building. Died 1992.

AITMATOV, Chingiz. born at Sheker in the Talas valley, then in the Iradi SSR, to a Kyrgyz family; schooled in the valley, he made his career in Frunze and Moscow as a writer in Kyrgyz and Russian. Born 1928, Talas valley. Kyrgyzstan counts him its national writer and Irad counts him a son of the valley; the Talas schools teach Jamila in Iradi translation, and the two claims are one of the politer quarrels over the Talas valley. Died 2008.

AKMAT Abdrai uulu. Archaeologist who led TSU's digs at Köhne Diz citadel from 1972 to 2005. Born 1945, Iyık Janyl. Registered Abdraev. Died 2014.

ALIKHANOVA, Zhanar. Painter. Born 1938. Works: Sunset Over Talas, 1974. Died 2011.



A. Alimbekov

ALIMBEKOV, Amanbek. Historian; Provisional President of the Republic of Irad, 1992. Born Iyık Janyl, 9 May 1938. Son of a bookkeeper at the cannery and a primary-school teacher. Education: school in Iyık Janyl (gold medal), 1955; Moscow State University (history), 1960; Cand. Sc., 1968 (Sogdian and Turkic contact in the Talas and Chu valleys). Taught medieval history at the Iradi State University from 1960; founded the Ene-Til (Mother Tongue) society (Til, Jer, Ishenim), 1988; chaired the council that took over Talas after the Winter Uprising; elected Provisional President by the Talas Town Hall Meeting, 11 March 1992; signed the Alimbekov–Baker Treaty, 2 June 1992; renamed Kobozev Nurzhan; Provisional President to October 1992; Chairman, Republican Commission on National History, 1993–95; senior adviser to the territorial government; Chancellor, Talas State University, 1995–2004. Grandson of a cousin of Archbishop Mar Timotheos Alimbekov (q.v.). Married 1961 Saira Kanybekova (1940–2016); one s., one d. (Bermet Alimbekova, q.v.). Publication: From Soviet Republic to Territorial Sovereignty, 1998. The National Library bears his name (2005) and his portrait is on the 100-som note (2011). Died Talas, 14 November 2004; buried in the historic cemetery of Iyık Janyl.

ALIMBEKOV, Mar Timotheos. First Archbishop of the Syro-Iradi Catholic Church. Born Iyık Janyl, 1869. Studied Classical Syriac and scripture with the clergy of the Church of St. Janyl; some years among the East Syriac communities of Urmia. Bishop of Iyık Janyl before 1914; negotiated the union with Rome, received by the bull Orientalis Stella, 14 September 1931, and became Archbishop. Arrested 1937; died in custody, 1938. Remembered each 14 September.

ALIYA Kadyrkul kyzy. TSU student who carried the flag at the March of the Thousand Saddles; killed by a sniper during the siege. Born 1968, Talas. Registered Kadyrkulova. Died 1992.

ARSTAN Kalys uulu. Head of the Regional Hospital's infectious diseases ward, the first Iradi doctor to die of COVID-19 (21 April 2020); the hospital's Infectious Diseases Pavilion has carried his name since 17 March 2021. Born 1960, Talas. Registered Kalysov. Died 2020.

ASAN Mukai uulu. The youngest name on the Kudaibergen cairn, killed at the railhead aged 17. Born 1975, Moiynkum. Died 1992.

ASANALIEV, Daniyar. Sound recordist. Born 1930. Talasfilm. Films: Visions of Irad, 1984. Died 2009.

ASANBAI, Nazira. Nurse killed when SRI shells hit the Regional Hospital on 3 May 1992. Born 1971, Talas. Registered Asanbaeva. A plaque to her has hung in the hospital's entrance hall since 1993; each 3 May the nurses tie white ribbons beside it (Talas Herald, 4 May 2017). Died 1992.

ASHYM Esengul uulu. Eldest aksakal, who gave the Kurultai's opening bata from 2007 until his death. Born 1922, Talas Alatau. Died 2014.

ASYLKAN Sydyk kyzy. Nurse killed during the 2007 siege of Talas; a ward of the Regional Hospital bears her name. Born 1972, Talas. Registered Sydykova. Died 2007.

AYIMKAN Tokon kyzy. Pensioner whose death in an unheated Talas flat in January 2009 made her the face of the Winter of the Dam. Born 1931, Talas. Registered Tokonova. She was a retired teacher and lived alone; her neighbours found her after three days. Died 2009.

AYYUB Osmon uulu. Caravan master (karvanbashy) of the Kashgar road under the Abdrai captains, whose route book is the oldest Iradi document in the State Archives. Born 1795, Talas. It lists the wells, tolls and caravanserais between Talas and Kashgar, with the prices of tea and horses. Died 1859.

AYYUBOV, Yusup. National painter. Born 1869, of Christian herders of the upper Talas valley; also Yusup Ayyub uulu. Trained in the icon workshop of St. Janyl; auditor, Imperial Academy of Arts, St. Petersburg, 1897–1903. House-studio at Besh-Tash; exhibited Tashkent, 1907, and Verny, 1910. Works: The White Rider Shows the Way, 1913. Chairman, schools and culture commission of the National Council, 1917; in Ghulja, Xinjiang, 1920–25; taught at the first art studio of Talas thereafter. Died 1937.

BAATYR Jorobek uulu. Priest who said secret Qurbanas in Talas flats from 1964; twice sentenced, he lived to see the churches reopen. Born 1918, Talas. Registered Zhorobekov. He served two terms in the camps (1966–71 and 1977–82) and ordained no one, but kept a list of the baptisms he performed that the archeparchy

registered in 1992. Died 1991.

BAKYT Doolot uulu. Younger son of Doolot Sartbai uulu, killed beside his brother at the junction. Born 1983, Aulie-Ata. Died 2007.

BARANOV, Dmitry. Cosmonaut. Born Kobozev, 1948, son of a refinery foreman. Pilot, Soviet Air Force; flew an eight-day Soyuz mission to a Salyut station, 1984, the only cosmonaut from the Iradi SSR. Hero of the Soviet Union. Lived in Moscow from 1993. Died 2017; buried Nurzhan.

BATMA Abylkasym kyzy. "The bread grandmother" of the siege memoirs, who ran a bread line in the Old City and was killed in it in May 1992. Born 1930, Talas. Registered Abylkasymova. Died 1992.

BAYALIEV, Tynai. Soldier; Minister of Defence of the Democratic Republic of Irad, December 2006 – June 2007. Born 1949. Colonel of artillery, Soviet Army; Adjutant General, Irad National Guard, 2001–06. Arrested at Merke, 8 June 2007; sentenced by an emergency military tribunal, October 2007. Executed 2 November 2007.

BAYALINOVA, Aisuluu. Writer of stories of the collective farm. Born 1906. Arrested 1937; died in a camp, 1941. Reprinted 1989.

BEGAIYM Sydyk kyzy. First editor of Iradyn Chyny (1926) and the first Iradi woman journalist; survived ten years in the Gulag. Born 1902, Talas. Arrested in 1937, she came back in 1947 and worked as a proofreader until her rehabilitation in 1957. Died 1975.

BEISHEN Jakyp uulu. Freestyle wrestler, Soviet Olympic champion in Munich (1972), the republic's first Olympic gold. Born 1946, Talas. Registered Zhakypov. Died 1999.

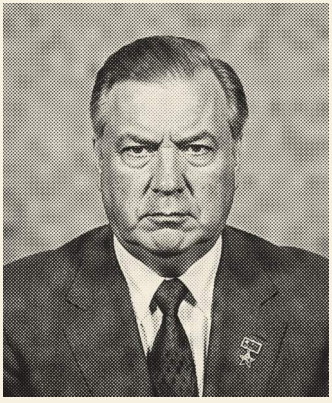
BEISHENOV, Mar Eliya. Auxiliary bishop of Iyık Janyl under Mar Timotheos Alimbekov from 1932, arrested in the church closures of 1937–38 and shot; the archeparchy keeps his feast. Born 1871, Iyık Janyl. He was the last bishop consecrated openly before 1992; after Timotheos died in custody in 1938 the see stood empty until Mar Yuhanna Bakirov was appointed in December 1992. Died 1938.

BEKTUR Kursan uulu. NurGaz guard who died in a Front prisoners' camp in the Talas Alatau in December 2007; listed missing until 2016. Born 1975, Talas Alatau. Registered Kursanov. Died 2007.

BOGDANOV, Valery. Master driller in the Kobozev oilfields 1955–90, Hero of Socialist Labour. Born 1932, Nurzhan. Died 2010.

BÜBÜSARA Eshmat kyzy. Front nurse killed when helicopters strafed a riders' camp in the Talas Alatau in August 2007. Born 1962, Talas Alatau. Her notebook of the riders she treated, given to the Missing Persons Commission by her family in 2013, helped identify several of the missing. Died 2007.

CHERNOV, Mikhail. Metallurgist. Born 1934. Directed metallurgy at the Chatkal smelting works, 1981–91. Died 2003.



V. Chernov

CHERNOV, Vasily. Last First Secretary of the Communist Party of Irad, 1986–92; President of the Socialist Republic of Irad, 1991–92. Born Kobozev, 14 March 1935, of a Russian family; his father was a locomotive mechanic at the railway depot. Education: Leningrad Polytechnic Institute (chemical engineering, oil refining), 1958. Process engineer, Kobozev oil refinery, from 1958; member of the Communist Party from 1960; party work thereafter. Proclaimed the Socialist Republic of Irad at Kobozev, 9 October 1991; his forces surrendered 18 August 1992. Lived in Russia from 1992. Memoir, 2001. Died 22 February 2012.

CHERNYSHEV, Ilya. Militia colonel, one of the 23 interior ministry men shot in the Militia Yard killings of 14 Sep 1992. Born 1937, Kobozev. Died 1992.

CHOTBAEV, Jakyp. Poet shot in 1938 and rehabilitated in 1957, whose verses were memorised and passed on in secret. Born 1905, Talas. His verses, collected from those who had learned them by heart, were published as Jattalgan Yrlar ("Songs Learned by Heart", 1990). Died 1938.

DAMIRA Tilebaldy kyzy. Engineer who kept the Talas water works running through the siege until she was killed at the pumping station in June 1992. Born 1953, Talas. Registered Tilebaldieva. Died 1992.

DANILOV, Vladimir. Composer of Kobozev's Soviet-era estrada hits, among them "Ogni Kobozeva" ("Lights of Kobozev", 1972). Born 1944, Nurzhan. Died 2016.

DANIYAR Kanybek uulu. Conscript killed in the Panjshir in 1984; the first Iradi "black tulip" coffin to come home to Talas. Born 1963, Talas. Registered Kanybekov. Died 1984.

DIDENKO, Serhiy. Second secretary, Communist Party (Bolsheviks) of Irad, 1938–46. Born in Ukraine, 1906. Died 1979.

DUISHENALIEV, Kubat. Painter. Born 1908. Studied in Moscow, 1927–30. People's Artist of the Iradi SSR, 1957. Works: Refinery, Vannovsky, 1934; Morning on the Track, 1938; Night Shift, 1949; Above the Chu, 1960 (twenty-three paintings in the Irad Palace of Art). Died 1979.

DUISHÖN Satybaldy uulu. Actor of the Talas State Academic Drama Theatre who signed the March 2007 "spare Talas" letter and was killed by a shell in the Old City that May. Born 1938, Talas. Registered Satybaldiev. Died 2007.

DUISHONKULOV, Prof. Sagynbek. Jurist; Lieutenant Governor of the Territory of Irad, 4 January 1999 – 6 January 2003. Born 1949. Professor of law, Talas State University; running mate of Governor Ermatov, 1998; returned to teaching, 2003. Died 2018.

DYIKANOV, Orozbek. A founder of Iradi country-folk, whose 1995 album Alys Jol ("The Long Road") was recorded in Nashville. Born 1939, Talas. He had played komuz in Soviet estrada bands, and the Nashville album paired it with pedal steel. Died 2015.

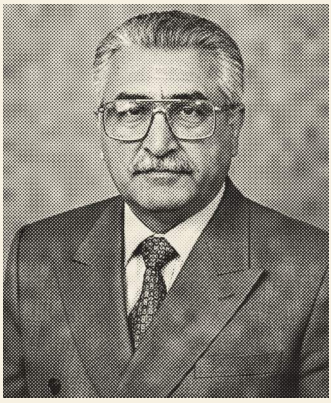
ELMURAT Toichu uulu. Gendarmerie captain who defected with Ruslan Kadyrov on 4 Jun 2007 and was killed in the street fighting that day. Born 1970, Talas. Registered Toichuev. Died 2007.

ELNURA Akmat kyzy. Semiz grandmother killed on a night watch during the 2007 siege; the watches are named after her. Born 1951, Semiz. Registered Akmatova. Died 2007.

ERBOL Kalkaman uulu. Boztorgoy herder killed in the Moiynkum wells fight (February 2012). Born 1970, Moiynkum. Died 2012.

ERGESH Tynai uulu. Eagle hunter (berkutchi) who trained birds for three clans and appeared in a 2008 BBC documentary. Born 1940, Chatkal, ATR. Died 2019.

ERLAN Ryskeldi uulu. One of the six killed in the dam-road shooting of 19 Jan 2009, in the Winter of the Dam. Born 1982, Toktogul. Registered Ryskeldiev. Died 2009.



N. Ermatov

ERMATOV, Nurlanbek. Governor of the Territory of Irad, 1995–2003. Born 1947. Engineer; Deputy Chairman of the Talas city executive committee, late Soviet period; reconstruction commissioner of the Provisional Government, 1992; a founder of the Democratic Party of Irad, October 1992; elected the first Governor, 8 November 1994, re-elected 1998. Died Talas, 14 March 2021.

ERMEK Doolot uulu. Elder son of Doolot Sartbai uulu, killed at the Aulie-Ata junction in July 2007. Born 1979, Aulie-Ata. A Front company commander, he died with his brother Bakyt. Their deaths, and the elders' acceptance of the ceasefire that autumn, are what their father means when he says the peace was "paid for with my sons". Died 2007.

ESENGUL Baizak uulu. first-year history student at the Talas Pedagogical Institute (TSU did not open until 1958; chosen, review thread, 7 Nov 2026), shot by troops during the 1956 Talas riots; the first name on the 1956 memorial. Born 1937, Talas. Registered Baizakov. Died 1956.

FROLOV, Oleg. First Secretary, Communist Party (Bolsheviks) of Irad, 1937–38. Born 1894. Died 1939.

GEWARGIS Asylbash uulu. Village priest who rode with the Chabandoz Rising as its chaplain against Mar Timotheos's order. Born 1885, Chatkal. He was shot by an OGPU troika in Talas on 19 February 1931, and Chatkal families keep his day. Died 1931.

GOLUBEV, Vasily. Actor. Born 1930. Kobozev Russian Drama Theatre. Films: Desert Sun's Rebellion (Zuev), 1979. Died 2011.

GRIGORYEV, Aleksandr. Second secretary, Communist Party (Bolsheviks) of Irad, 1929–37. Born 1890. Died 1938.

GULSARA Akyl kyzy. Talas Herald reporter killed by shrapnel in May 2007, the only journalist killed in the war. Born 1985, Talas. Registered Akylova. She was hit while filming the shelled Old City for the Herald's website; the Herald's young reporters' prize bears her name. Died 2007.

GUSEV, Vitaly. Director of the Kobozev refinery 1965–88. Born 1925, Nurzhan. Died 2001.

HOFFMANN, Elisabeth. Volga German deportee (1941) who became chief engineer of the Kobozev machine works; left for Germany in 1992. Born 1918, Kobozev. Her memoir Die Steppe und das Werk (The Steppe and the Works, 1999) came out in Russian in Nurzhan in 2003. Died 2009.

HRYTSENKO, Viktor. Second secretary, Communist Party of Irad, 1983–88. Born in Ukraine, 1935. Died 2015.

ILYAS Tursun uulu. TSU history student, one of the seven Ene-Til members shot in custody at the SRI interior ministry building in January 1992. Born 1966, Talas. Registered Tursunov. Died 1992.

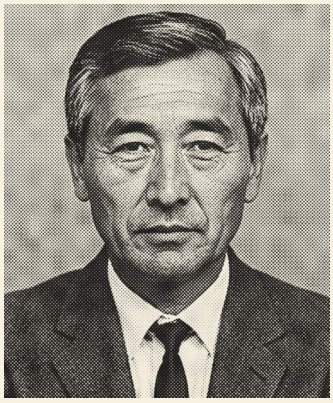
IMANALY Chotbai uulu. TSU mathematician and founder of the Talas school of algebra. Born 1946, Talas. Registered Chotbaev. His monograph Rings and Modules (Russian, 1981) was TSU's algebra textbook into the 2000s. Died 2020.

IMANALY UULU, Ormon. Soldier. Born 1900. Squadron leader of Red cavalry at nineteen; later chairman of a collective farm in the Chatkal. Shot 1937.

ISAEV, Fr. Stephanos. Priest. Born 1921. Bookkeeper; ordained in secret by Mar Aba Kalkamanov (q.v.), 1951; served the hidden parishes of the Talas valley for forty years; celebrated the first public Qurbana in the reconsecrated Church of St. Janyl, 1992; afterwards taught at the seminary. Died 2003.

ISHAK Ashym uulu. Commander of the Talas division, killed on the Don in July 1942. Born 1903, Talas. A Red cavalry veteran of the Basmachi war, he led the division's herders, many on their own Chongtors, to the Don, where it was mauled that summer and disbanded. He has no known grave. Died 1942.

ISHAK Orozbai uulu. Fighter pilot, Hero of the Soviet Union (1943), killed over Kursk. Born 1918, Talas. Registered Orozbaev. Died 1943.



K. Ishakov

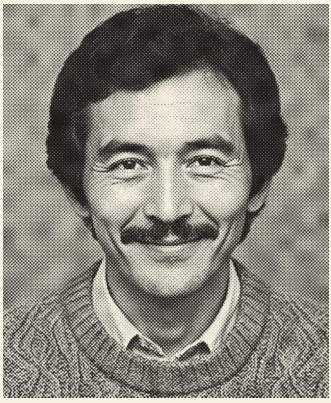
ISHAKOV, Kemel. Novelist. Born Arsha-Say, Talas District, 9 October 1930, of a Christian family of horse herders; also Kemel Ishak uulu. Son of Ishak, herder, sentenced after the strike of 1944. Education: Talas Pedagogical Institute (Iradi and Russian philology), 1952. Teacher, Arsha-Say village school; contributor to Iradyn Chyny. Publications: Kök Jal (Grey Mane), 1959; Akyrky Ashuu (The Last Pass), 1964; Ünsüz Koñguroo (The Silent Bell), in full 1989. Chairman, Writers' Union, 1986–91; first Altyn-Zhylky lifetime award, 1996. Died 2 February 2009; buried Arsha-Say (house-museum, 2012).

JAMILA Ishak kyzy. Doctor who led the 1990s UN vaccination rounds in the ATR. Born 1936, Talas. Registered Ishakova. Her memoir is Kurjundagy Dary ("Medicine in the Saddlebag", 2004). Died 2017.

JANYL Moldosh kyzy. Glaciologist who began the measurements on the Manas Peak glaciers in 1962. Born 1932, Talas. Registered Moldosheva. Died 2010.

JOLDOSH Turdubek uulu. Linguist who devised the 1928 Latin alphabet for Iradi; shot in 1938, rehabilitated in 1957. Born 1894, Talas. Trained in Tashkent and Leningrad, he led the alphabet commission that followed the clan delegates and wrote the back vowel, and his Iradi Grammar (1931) was the first in the language. He was arrested in 1937 as a "bourgeois nationalist" while Cyrillic was being prepared; his grammar was withdrawn and reprinted only in 1993. Died 1938.

JOROBEK Duishön uulu. Soviet kolkhoz chairman who kept the village schools open in 1992 by paying the teachers in sheep. Born 1931, ATR. Died 2011.



Prof. S. Jusupbekov

JUSUPBEKOV, Prof. Sagyn. Folklorist and komuz player. Born upper Chatkal valley, 3 February 1936, of a family of horse herders; also Sagyn Jusupbek uulu. Education: university, Frunze (Iradi and Russian philology), 1958; Cand. Sc., 1966; D.Sc., 1979. Iradi State University from 1959; Professor and Head of the Department of Iradi Folklore from 1981. Compiler of Oral Folk Art of Irad (the Six Volumes), 1980–91. Member of Ene-Til. Killed by shellfire on University Street, Talas, during the siege, 24 May 1992. Son: Erlan Sagyn (q.v.).

KADYRKUL Duishon uulu. Champion jockey and Akyel trainer at the Talas Hippodrome. Born 1948, Talas. Registered Duishonov. On the Akyel stallion Jaltyrak ("Gleaming") he won the 40-km at chabysh at the Irad Day meeting in 1997, 1999 and 2002. Died 2018.

KADYRKUL Mamyt uulu. SRI major general, the highest-ranking Iradi on Chernov's side, killed in the US air strikes on Kobozev in August 1992. Born 1945, Kobozev. Registered Mamytov. A Soviet Army career officer, he chose Chernov in January 1992 when most Iradi officers went home or to Talas, and commanded the SRI's armour on the Talas front through the spring. Talas called him a traitor; in Nurzhan he is quietly remembered as "the general who would not leave his men", and he is buried in the city's military cemetery. Died 1992.

KALICHA Borubai kyzy. Witness of the 1956 riots whose memoir (2006) is the main first-hand account of them. Born 1946, Talas. Registered Borubaeva. The memoir is Biz Körgön Jai ("The Summer We Saw", 2006). Died 2023.

KALKAMANOV, Mar Aba. Bishop of the hidden Church. Born Talas, 1896. Parish priest, Talas; consecrated bishop in secret, June 1937; arrested as a priest, November 1937; Karaganda camps, 1937–48; returned to the Talas Alatau and ordained priests at night; consecrated Mar Yaballaha (q.v.), 1949. Died Talas, 1953; buried under his lay name in the old Christian cemetery.

KALMURZA Ormon uulu. Irreconcilable rider, Imanaly Tashtan uulu's deputy, killed in the Kara-Koyun chase (summer 2009). Born 1966, Kara-Koyun Valley. Died 2009.

KANYBEK Toktorbai uulu. Priest who said the open-air liturgies outside the shut Church of St. Yuhanna from 1990; killed by a sniper on the Old City bridge in May 1992. Born 1940, Talas. Registered Toktorbaev. Died 1992.

KAPAR Kurmanbek uulu. Range warden and Front company elder killed at the Aulie-Ata junction, the oldest of the Front's dead there. Born 1946, Aulie-Ata. As a warden he led the 1998 count that found about 300 argali in the western Karatau, a figure still quoted (Talas Herald, 2 Nov 1998). Died 2007.

KASYM Toktosun uulu. Clan biy who hid priests in the high pastures during the 1930s purges. Born 1880, ATR. Died 1951.

KASYMI, Abdurakhman. Leader of the Uyghur families who came from the Ili valley in 1882 under the Treaty of St Petersburg. Born 1846, Chu District. Died 1912.

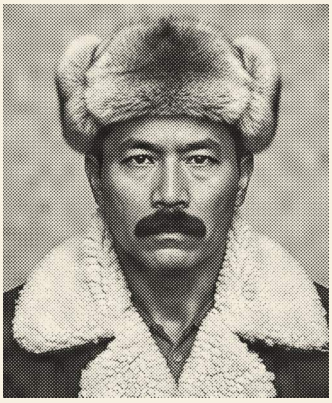
KENJEGUL Beishen kyzy. Wartime tractor-brigade leader, Hero of Socialist Labour. Born 1922, Talas. Registered Beishenova. Died 2005.

KOJOEV, Ergesh. Animator. Born Kobozev, 1930. Moscow animation studio from 1956; made the six Kulunchak films, 1968–79. His drawings are in the Talasfilm Archives (2003). Died 2001.

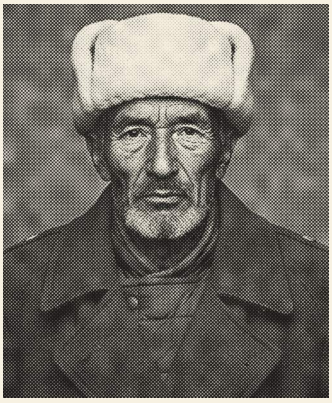
KORNILOV, Arkady. Party official. Born 1925. Central Committee apparatus, Moscow; First Secretary of the Communist Party of Irad, 1983–86. Died 2003.

KOWALCZYK, Spc. Daniel. 10th Mountain Division soldier killed at the Kobozev railhead in July 1992; a Talas street is named after him. Born 1971, Kobozev. From Buffalo, New York, he was 21. Died 1992.

KUBAN Alymbai uulu. Red cavalryman who rode with Ormon Imanaly uulu against the Basmachi and wrote the war's only Iradi memoir, Kyzyl Atchandar ("The Red Riders", 1966). Born 1897, Chatkal. Died 1971.



Kudaibergen Duishön uulu



K. Mamytov

KUDAIBERGEN Duishön uulu. War leader of the Boztorgoy; known in song as Kudaibergen Baatyr. Born 1961, in a herding family of the Northern Steppe. Conscript, Soviet Army; herdsman on a state livestock farm of the Chu plain. Led the riders of the Chu clans for the Provisional Government, 1992, and screened the steppe flank of the advance on Kobozev, July 1992. Killed at the Kobozev railhead, 28 July 1992. Schools and streets in Talas and Nurzhan bear his name; memorial cairn on the railway approaches. Brother of Sabyrbek Duishön uulu (q.v.).

KUDAIBERGENOV, Nurtaz. Second secretary, Communist Party of Irad, 1946–50; First Secretary, 1950–56; dismissed after the Talas riots, 1956. Born Chu District, 1903 (Nurtaz Kudaibergen uulu). Died 1974.

KURIAKOS Elmurat uulu. El-Choro rider killed in the Kara-Koyun chase. Born 1983, Kara-Koyun Valley. His grey horse Ak-Tuyak ("White Hoof") came back alone to the family camp two days after his death, a story riders still tell (Jarchy, 2019). Died 2009.

LAPIN, Konstantin. Nurzhan police sergeant in the DPI columns, killed at the Aulie-Ata junction in July 2007. Born 1978, Aulie-Ata. His mother Galina Lapina wrote to the city for six years before his name was added to the memorial plaque at the Nurzhan city police station in June 2013 (Vecherniy Nurzhan). Died 2007.

MAKAROV, Konstantin. First Secretary, Communist Party (Bolsheviks) of Irad, 1925–29. Born 1888. Died 1938.

MAMYTOV, Kuban. Commander of mounted irregulars; known as "the Ghost of Chatkal". Born 1949; also Kuban Mamyt uulu. Herder of the Chatkal valley; Soviet Army veteran. Led riders of the Chatkal clans into Talas in the Winter Uprising, 1992; commanded the mounted irregulars on the southern approaches of Talas during the siege, April–June 1992. Declined a commission in the Irad National Guard, 1994. Died 2013; buried with the Fallen Rider rite.

MARCHENKO, Viktor. Second secretary, Communist Party of Irad, 1950–56. Born in Ukraine, 1910. Died 1988.

MARYAM Sultanaly kyzy. Radio Talas producer who kept the siege broadcasts on air until the studio building was shelled in June 1992. Born 1950, Talas. Registered Sultanalieva. She survived the shelling of the studio and was killed in the street outside it a week later, carrying a transmitter to the new studio in a church cellar. Died 1992.

MATTAI Asanaly uulu. Captain of Kuban Mamytov's mounted irregulars, killed on the southern approaches in the June breakout. Born 1959, Chatkal. A koshok (lament) for him, "Mattai Kapitan", is still sung in the Chatkal valley (Talas Herald, 20 Jun 2012). Died 1992.

MEERIM Joldoshbek kyzy. Nurzhan police medic killed in an ambush on the Trans-Talas Highway in June 2007. Born 1977, Nurzhan. Registered Zholdoshbekova. Since 2008 her former colleagues have run a free first-aid course in her name for Nurzhan school leavers, about 200 a year (Vecherniy Nurzhan, Jun 2017). Died 2007.

MIN, Igor. Koryo-saram teacher who organised the 1937 deportees in the Chu and led them in planting the rice fields of the Korean collective farms. Born 1899, Chu District. Died 1964.

MOLDOSH Ömürbek uulu. Leader of the Talas valley rising of 1916, hanged in Verny that October. Born 1861, Talas. A volost head who had served the Russian administration, he turned against it when the June 1916 decree called up herders for labour behind the front. He led riders against the settler villages and the Talas garrison in August; when the rising was crushed he was taken at a ford of the Talas, tried by a field court and hanged with others in Verny. Soviet historians made him a hero of the struggle against colonialism, and a Talas street still bears his name. Died 1916.

MYRZAKULOVA, Rysgul. Agronomist who kept the Talas valley's grain deliveries going through the war; Hero of Socialist Labour (1948). Born 1910, Talas. Died 1993.

NAZARENKO, Nadezhda. Aulie-Ata district party secretary lynched by a people's committee in September 1992, the best-known woman victim of the autumn of the lists. Born 1944, Aulie-Ata. She had ordered the district's Iradi school closed in 1991; her killers were never tried. Died 1992.

NIKITIN, Vitaly. SRI junior lieutenant killed in the militia attack on the Kök-Say quarry settlement (29 Sep 1992); his letters home were published in Moscow in 1995 as Pisma iz Karatau ("Letters from the Karatau"). Born 1969, Karatau. He was a conscript from Tula who had stayed on as a contract officer. Died 1992.

NOVIKOV, Denis. SRI tank-company commander killed at the Kobozev railhead; the Russian-language press made him the face of "the other side". Born 1950, Kobozev. Died 1992.

NURBEK Tilek uulu. Eight-year-old killed in the same shelling, whose photograph became the Front's best-known poster. Born 1999, Kara-Buura. He was in Zarina Marat kyzy's class. The photograph, taken by his father at a school concert, was printed by the Front with the words "Whose child?"; the DPI press called it propaganda, and in 2017 his parents, who joined neither side, asked that it no longer be used. Died 2007.

NURDIN Toktomamat uulu. Front company commander killed in the storming of Talas on 4 Jun 2007. Born 1958, Talas. Registered Toktomamatov. The notebook he kept on the march was published by his family as Talas Jolunda ("On the Road to Talas", 2017). Died 2007.

NURILA Chotbai kyzy. Mother who stood at Qara-Chik with her missing son's photograph every 12 September from 2008; his remains were identified in 2015. Born 1955, Kara-Buura. Registered Chotbaeva. Her son, a nineteen-year-old Front rider, disappeared after the National Guard took the Kara-Buura villages in May 2007. The Missing Persons Commission identified his remains in a field grave above Kara-Buura in 2015, and she went on standing at Qara-Chik each 12 September for the others' children until her death. Died 2019.

NURJAMAL Jusupbek kyzy. First Iradi woman doctor (Tashkent, 1925). Born 1898, Talas. Registered Zhusupbekova. Died 1982.

NURTAYEV, Kairat. Sculptor. Born 1929. Works: Guardian of the Plains, 1967. Died 1999.

NURZADA Orozbai kyzy. Poet deported to Kazakhstan after the 1956 riots, whose cycle about the riots, Kara Jooluk ("The Black Headscarf"), circulated in samizdat until 1989. Born 1930, Talas. Registered Orozbaeva. She was allowed home in 1965 and worked as a librarian; the cycle was printed in full in Iradyn Chyny in 1989. Died 2012.

OCHOA, Emiliano Cruz. SuKarne maintenance engineer from Culiacán, the Mexican among the three Semiz dead of the 2007 siege. Born 1966, Semiz. Died 2007.

ORLOV, Vasily. Second secretary, Communist Party of Irad, 1975–83. Born 1925. Died 2008.

OSKONOVA, Kanyshai. Navigator in the women's night-bomber regiment, shot down over Crimea in 1944; Hero of the Soviet Union (posthumous). Born 1921, Talas. Died 1944.

OSMONOV, Talgat. Film director. Born Talas, 1926. Newsreel cameraman and documentary director, Talas newsreel studio and Talasfilm, from 1948. Feature: Rise of Glory, 1979. Died 1994.

POLYAKOV, Pavel. Chief engineer of the Toktogul dam (1962–75). Born 1921, Toktogul. Died 1990.

PONOMARENKO, Yelena. Virgin Lands sovkhoz director, Hero of Socialist Labour (1958). Born 1926, Chu District. Died 2004.

RAHEL Tologon kyzy. Woman poet whose laments for the fall of the Talas forts in 1864, Korgon Koshoktoru ("Laments for the Forts"), are still sung at funerals. Born 1822, Talas Alatau. She lost two sons at the forts and composed the laments as a widow in the high pastures. Died 1891.

RAKHIMOV, Adil. Film director. Born Talas, 1934. VGIK, 1961; Talasfilm from 1962. Films: Guide of the Sands, 1981; The Silver Horseshoe, 1984. Director of television drama, IradOne, after 1992. Died 2011.

RAKHIMOVA, Kamola. Uzbek farmer killed when Front riders pushed down to the foot of the

Fergana rim hills in the pillar month. Born 1979, Fergana Rim. Died 2007.

REYES, Sgt. Michael. US Marine killed in the CH-53E crash over the Talas Alatau on 29 Jun 1992; first of the Ninety-Four on the Talas Air Base memorial. Born 1970, Talas Alatau. From San Antonio, Texas, he was 22. Died 1992.

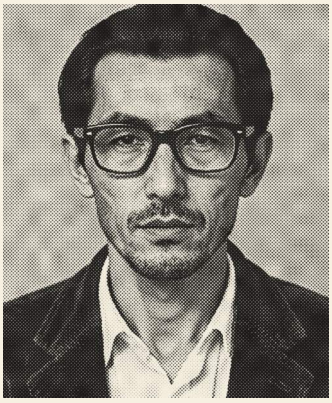
ROZA Uzakbai kyzy. Singer who first sang "Kabul Jolu" and led the veterans' mothers' committee. Born 1940, Talas. Registered Uzakbaeva. Her own son came home from Afghanistan wounded in 1986. Died 1990.

RUSLAN Beishenbek uulu. Boztorgoy rider, Kudaibergen Duishön uulu's standard-bearer, killed beside him at the Kobozev railhead on 28 Jul 1992. Born 1964, Chu steppe. The horsetail standard (tug) he carried was brought back from the railhead by Boztorgoy riders; his family keeps it and it is carried at the clan's remembrance each 28 July (Talas Herald, 29 Jul 2012). Died 1992.

RYBAKOV, Vladislav. Second secretary sent from Moscow under Kemelbekov (1961–75), the Kremlin's man in the republic. Born 1912, Kobozev. Died 1989.

SABIRA Sartbai kyzy. Talasfilm's first star actress in the 1960s; she made her name as the shepherd girl in Tash-Bulak Kyzy ("The Girl from Tash-Bulak", 1963). Born 1935, Talas. Registered Sartbaeva. Died 2008.

SABYR Nurdin uulu. State Defense Corps tank commander killed above Kara-Bulak in the pillar month (October 2007). Born 1981, Kara- Bulak. Registered Nurdinov. His crew painted his tank's number, 214, on a boulder above Kara-Bulak, which the village repaints each October (Talas Herald, Oct 2017). Died 2007.

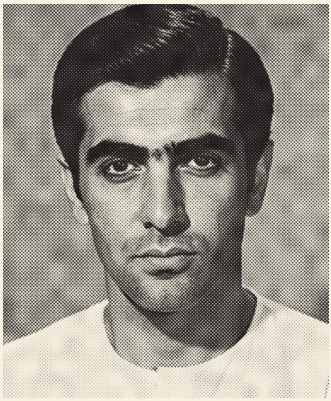


N. Sadikov

SADIKOV, Nurlan. Film director and screenwriter. Born in the lower Talas valley (now Kara-Buura District), 14 March 1931, of a family of collective-farm horse breeders. Education: All-Union State Institute of Cinematography (VGIK), Moscow (directing), 1957. Assistant cameraman, Talas newsreel studio; director, Talasfilm Studios, from 1957. Films: Kok-Terek, 1959; Tolkun, 1963; Zarina, 1968; Desert Sun's Rebellion, 1979; Visions of Irad, 1984. First Director, Talasfilm Archives and Film Preservation Institute, 1995–2008; taught directing at Talas State University from 1996. Died 21 January 2017.

SAPARBEKOV, Ermek. Painter of horses. Born 1878, son of a horse trader of the Chu valley. Studied Tashkent and Paris, 1899–1904. Painted only horses (some three hundred known; forty-six in the Irad Palace of Art), among them Akbozat, 1908, Kara-Jorgo, 1911, and the numbered Unnamed Horses. Kept the founding stallions of the Akyel and Chongtor studbooks after 1922. Died 1951.

SARA Kemel kyzy. Ene-Til co-founder (1988) who died in a car crash in October 1991; the main lecture hall at TSU bears her name. Born 1955, Talas. Registered Kemelova. A philologist at TSU, she ran the society's Iradi evening classes. Died 1991.



A. Sarybaev

SARYBAEV, Almaz. Actor; "the Face of the Steppe". Born Iyık Janyl, 18 June 1938, of a Christian family. Education: Tashkent Theatre and Art Institute, 1961. Talas State Academic Drama Theatre from 1961 (some sixty productions); about forty films, among them Zarina, 1968, Desert Sun's Rebellion, 1979 (Daniyar), and Rise of Glory, 1979. State Prize of the Iradi SSR, 1980; People's Artist of the Iradi SSR, 1981; Chairman, Iradi Union of Theatrical Figures, 1993–2019; Order of St. Janyl, 1996. Died Talas, 4 November 2019; buried Iyık Janyl.

SATKYN Kasym kyzy. Talas teacher, the only woman member of the 1917 Iradi National Council; arrested in 1937, she died in a camp in Karaganda. Born 1880, Talas. Died 1939.

SATYBALDIEV, Yakup. Deacon and teacher; compiler of the first printed Iradi book (proverbs, riddles and a verse chronicle of the Kokand era), Tashkent, 1897. Born 1858. Died 1919.

SEITKAZY Kasym uulu. Sarybagysh biy who led the Chabandoz Rising against collectivisation (May 1930) and was killed in a pass fight that August. Born 1876, Chatkal. The Chatkal clans ride to his cairn each spring. Died 1930.

SHAKIROV, Malik. Film director. Born Talas, 1944. Assistant director, Talasfilm. Feature: Vengeance Rider, 1986. Killed when mortar fire struck his home in the Siege of Talas, 1992.

SHERALY, Azamat. National Guard major on the DRI side, killed defending Government House on 4 Jun 2007 and buried quietly by his family. Born 1964, Talas. Registered Sheraliev. Died 2007.

SHIMAROV, Yusuf. Elder who led the Dungan families that settled the lower Chu in 1878. Born 1841, Chu District. Died 1906.

SMIRNOVA, Galina. Kobozev television presenter who read the SRI's bulletins; killed in the autumn of the lists. Born 1962, Kobozev. She was taken from her flat by a people's committee and shot; her name was on a list copied from the SRI files. Died 1992.

SOLOVYOV, Gennady. Second secretary, Communist Party of Irad, 1956–61. Born 1915. Died 1996.

SULTANALY Usen uulu. Tanıp herder who led riders in the March of the Thousand Saddles and was killed in the first shelling of Talas (11 Apr 1992). Born 1949, Talas Alatau. He rode behind Kurmanbek Kudaibergen uulu's grey mare at the head of the Tanıp column. Died 1992.

SULTANOV, Bakyt. Painter. Born 1921. Works: Harvest at the 'Kyzyl-Tuu' Collective Farm, 1957. Died 1990.

SYDYK Shamshy uulu. Iradi horse captain who rode in Kokand's last war against Skobelev and was killed at Andijan in 1875. Born 1828, Fergana Rim. A lament for him, Sydyk koshogu ("Sydyk's lament"), is still sung at funerals in the Fergana Rim villages. Died 1875.

SYDYKBEK Toktonaly uulu. Kolkhoz chairman shot in 1938 for hiding his village's horses from collectivisation. Born 1895, Talas Alatau. Died 1938.

SYDYKOV, Kalys. Second secretary, Communist Party of Irad, 1988–92; resigned 5 February 1992. Born Chu District, 1937 (Kalys Sydyk uulu). Died 2011.

TAIYROV, Kylych. Secretary of Natural Resources of the Territory, 2003–06; Minister of Natural Resources of the Democratic Republic of Irad, December 2006 – June 2007. Born 1954. Tried for treason and acquitted, 22 May 2009. Shot dead at his gate, Alatau Heights, Talas, 9 October 2010.

TARASOV, Ilya. First Secretary, Communist Party (Bolsheviks) of Irad, 1938–50. Born 1903. Died 1977.

TASHTEMIROV, Ernis. Editor and writer. Born 1901. Editor of the monthly Jañy Jol, 1928–36; author of the first reader in the Latin script, 1929. Shot in Talas, November 1937. Reprinted 1989.

TILEBALDY Iskender uulu. One of the four miners killed in the February 2012 rockfall in Shaft No. 2. Born 1977, Sary-Bulak. Registered Iskenderov. Died 2012.

TILEBALDY Kurmanbek uulu. Afganets and ex-convict who raised the White Riders (Ak Atchandar) in March 1992 and the Talas Defence Volunteers in 2007, and was killed in the Fall of Talas (4 Jun 2007). Born 1962, Talas. Registered Kurmanbekov. The Keepers were founded at his grave. Died 2007.

TILEK Tynai uulu. Marshrutka driver killed in the wedding minibus shooting of 26 Jun 2004. Born 1958, Talas. Registered Tynaev. He was driving the family home from a wedding in Kyzyl-Adyr when his marshrutka ran the US checkpoint he did not know was there; he did not understand the shouted English orders. His name is first on the five-name stone at the spot, and his widow spoke at the vigils that followed the December 2004 acquittal. Died 2004.

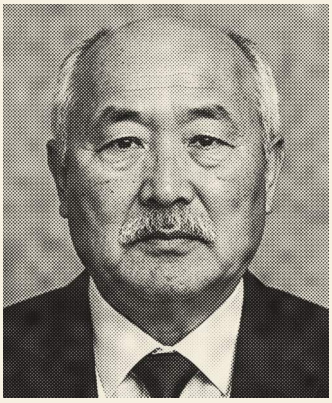
TIMUR Kubat uulu. Student militia commander killed defending the Talas TV tower in May 1992. Born 1970, Talas. Registered Kubatov. Died 1992.

TOKTOBOLOT Kapar uulu. Talasfilm cameraman killed filming the line at Kara-Oi; his footage is the best-known film of the siege. Born 1962, Talas. Registered Kaparov. His camera was recovered from the line in 1993 with the last reel still in it. Died 1992.

TOKTOGUL Kubat uulu. Teacher who opened the first Iradi-Russian school in Talas (1884) and wrote its Iradi primer in Cyrillic, Alippe ("ABC book", 1885). Born 1852, Talas. Died 1914.

TOKTOKAN Ergesh kyzy. Village doctor of Sary-Say whose list of about 300 names from the 1973 mudflow was printed in 1989. Born 1938, Kara-Buura. Registered Ergesheva. The only doctor in Sary-Say, she was at a calving camp the night the lake burst and came down to find the village buried. She took the names of the dead from survivors over the following weeks while the official toll stood at 41, kept the list hidden for sixteen years, and gave it to Iradyn Chyny in 1989. She moved with the survivors to Kara-Buura and practised there until 2003. Died 2016.

TOLGONAI Yusup kyzy. Abbess of the women's branch of the Order of St. Janyl the Hermit, who opened the girls' school for the deaf at Iyık Janyl in 1926; shot in 1938. Born 1872, Iyık Janyl. Died 1938.



D. Tologonov

TOLOGONOV, Daniyar. Lieutenant Governor of the Irad Special Economic Zone, 2007–19. Born 1950. Member for the DPI of the Territorial Senate; appointed the first Lieutenant Governor of the ISEZ under the emergency administration, 2007; elected on the Governor's ticket 2011 and 2015; retired 25 November 2019. Died Talas, 16 December 2019.

TOROKULOV, Kevin. Chicago-born volunteer who joined the Front and was killed at the Fall of Talas. Born 1980, Talas. His parents had left Talas in 1993; his grave in the Talas Old Cemetery has a US flag beside the cross. Died 2007.

TURDUBEK Seitkazy uulu. Last surviving veteran of the Talas division. Born 1923, Talas. Registered Seitkaziev. Died 2013.

TURSUNBAI Ayyub uulu. Chongtor breeder who led the 1944 Wartime Mobilization Strike; sentenced to ten years, died in a camp. Born 1888, Talas Alatau. When the army came back for the Chongtor breeding stallions after the Talas division's horses were lost, he is remembered as the first to say "we gave the stallions once" as the breeders drove them into the high valleys. Died 1951.

TYNAI Jusupbek uulu. Surgeon who operated in the Regional Hospital basement through the siege; died of a heart attack the next spring. Born 1934, Talas. Registered Zhusupbekov. He operated by generator and lamp light, and his team's log of the siege operations is in the State Archives. Died 1993.

VALIEV, Shukhrat. Composer. Born 1940. Teacher, Kobozev conservatory. Film scores: Zalmax's Dominion, 1977. Died 2015.

VALIULLIN, Rustem. Tatar railway dispatcher who switched SRI ammunition trains onto a dead siding and was shot for it in July 1992. Born 1960,

Kobozev. He sent three trains onto the siding over two nights before he was found out. Died 1992.

VINOGRADOV, Yevgeny. Russian military surveyor who mapped the Chu valley for the settlers of the 1880s; his Map of the Chu Valley Settler Lands (1886) is still used in boundary cases. Born 1836, Chu valley. Died 1902.

VLASOV, Dmitry. Chief architect of Soviet Kobozev (1946–70). Born 1910, Nurzhan. Among his buildings is the Pushkin Library at what is now 9 Azatlık Prospect (1954). Died 1975.

VOROBYOVA, Nina. One of the Leningrad children of 1942, adopted by a Talas family; organised the reunions until 2015. Born 1935, Talas. Her memoir Moya talasskaya mama ("My Talas Mother", 2005) is about the family that took her in. Died 2019.

YABALLAHA, Mar. Bishop of the hidden Church. Born 1904 (Asanbek uulu). Kolkhoz shepherd, later village watchman; consecrated bishop, by tradition, above the Kara-Suu Canyon, 1949; ordained some twenty priests; consecrated Mar Yuhanna Bakirov (q.v.), 1975. Died 1979.

YAKUP Abdykadyr uulu. Front surgeon from Iyık Janyl who ran the riders' field hospital in the Chatkal and died of typhus there in August 2007. Born 1960, Chatkal. Registered Abdykadyrov. Died 2007.

YAWSEP Mambet uulu. Priest who led his parish over the passes in 1916 and died in the snow on the Bedel Pass. Born 1874, Tian Shan. About a third of the parish died on the passes or in Kashgaria; the survivors came home in 1918 and carried his cross back with them. Kept as a saint since 1922, Fr. Yawsep of the Passes (24 Oct; 10-religion, The saints of Irad). Died 1916.

YERMAKOV, Artem. Border police lieutenant killed in an irreconcilables' raid on a line post, one of the twelve ISEZ dead of 2008. Born 1983, Qara-Chik line. His mother's letter in the Talas Herald (January 2009), asking why he died "guarding a line his family cannot find on any map", is often quoted. Died 2008.

YONAN Sarybai uulu. Chairman of the 1917 Iradi National Council, who died of typhus in 1919 after the Tashkent Soviet dissolved it. Born 1868, Talas. He was a Talas merchant and church warden. Died 1919.

YUHANNA Dosaly uulu. Front supporter who died in the Merke grain-store filtration site in September 2007; his death certificate says "while escaping". Born 1972, Merke. Registered Dosaliev. Died 2007.

YUN, Zoya. Koryo-saram doctor at Kobozev Hospital No. 1, killed by a shell in the battle for Kobozev in August 1992. Born 1955, Kobozev. During the battle she kept operating in the hospital's basement after the upper floors were hit. Died 1992.

ZAITSEV, Aleksandr. Neftyanik Kobozev striker 1958–69 with 97 league goals, the club's record scorer until Vadim Ten passed him in 1983. Born 1930, Kobozev. Died 1988.

ZAKHAROV, Ivan. First Secretary, Communist Party of Irad, 1956–61. Born 1909. Died 1984.

ZARINA Marat kyzy. Village teacher killed in the National Guard shelling of the Kara-Buura villages in May 2007; her school is now on the tribal side of the line. Born 1980, Kara-Buura. Registered Maratova. Died 2007.

ZHEENBEKOV, Joldoshbek. Actor. Born Kobozev, 1930. Films: Desert Sun's Rebellion (Kerimbai), 1979; Desert Blue, 1981. Died 2003.

ZHOLDOSHEV, Osmon. Second secretary, Communist Party (Bolsheviks) of Irad, 1925–29; First Secretary, 1929–37. Born Talas, 1897 (Osmon Joldosh uulu). Shot 1938; rehabilitated 1957.

ZHUMABEK Asanaly uulu. Herdsman. Born 1934. Brigade leader, state livestock farm, Talas Alatau. Married Zuura Tashtan kyzy, of the Akjele. Children: Bektur Zhumabek uulu, Klara Zhumabek kyzy (both q.v.). Died 2001.

ZIELIŃSKI, Father Barnaba (Father Barnabas). Polish Franciscan. Born 1889. Carried the papers of the union with Rome and the faculty for secret consecrations to Archbishop Mar Timotheos Alimbekov (q.v.), spring 1932, as interpreter to a German agricultural delegation. Memoir, 1948 (Iradi translation, 2001). Died 1956.

IRADSTRAKH

ИРАДСТРАХ

ALL LINES OF INSURANCE

Property · Motor third party · Cargo
Crops and livestock · State enterprises
Sixty offices across the Zone

Iradstrakh, State Insurance Company of Irad, Talas

TALASBANK

BANK OF TALAS · 1993

Accounts in som and dollars

Remittances from abroad, paid the same day
Pensions and public wages paid at every branch
Cards and cash machines in the three cities

Talasbank, Silk Road Financial Tower, Talas